

ABOUT THIS EDITION

This is the Board and Investment Edition of the WEC-LC Ten-Year Institutional Master Plan. It sets out the institution the founders propose to establish, what it will teach and to whom, what that costs, what it will charge, how much capital it needs and when, and what the Board must decide at each step.

The plan is built from zero. It assumes an institution with no learners, no staff, no revenue and no recognition, and it takes nothing from any earlier document or record. Every figure in it is produced by the plan’s own model from 202 stated assumptions, each listed with its source in Appendix B: 70 are published external evidence, 73 are specifications the plan sets for the institution, and 59 are planning judgements that the College will replace with its own measurements as it operates.

Fees are stated at 2027 prices and rise three per cent a year. Every other sum is in the money of the year in which it falls. The College earns in US dollars and pays most of its costs in pounds; sterling is converted at 1.3417 dollars to the pound, the mean of the twelve monthly rates HMRC published from October 2025 to September 2026.

DOCUMENT

Title	WEC-LC Ten-Year Institutional Master Plan
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Ten stages, in the order the plan is built: the institution first, the numbers after.

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The plan in brief

WorldWide English College, London Campus, will be a new institution. It will teach English to adults in four regions of the world, online, from London, and award its own qualification at six levels. This plan sets out how it is established, what it will cost, what it will charge and when it will stand on its own income.

\$6.0M FOUNDING CAPITAL In three tranches, each released at a Board gate	2027 FIRST INTAKE Autumn term, in the Gulf, after two terms of establishment	2031 FIRST SURPLUS The first year fees exceed the whole cost of the institution	2035 CAPITAL RETURNABLE With a reserve of six months' cost complete in 2036
740 LEARNERS STUDYING, 2036 About 860 new learners a year	\$9.4M NET FEE REVENUE, 2036 Against \$7.4M of cost	55 STAFF, 2036 39 academic, 16 professional	\$3.7M RESERVE, 2036 Six months of operating cost

WHAT THE COLLEGE IS

The College offers one qualification in six levels, A1 to C2 on the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages. Every learner completes the same sixty modules, submits the same ten assignments at each level and sits the same examination, and every piece of assessed work is marked twice. The academic standard is one standard, whatever a learner pays.

What a learner chooses is the support they receive on the way. There are five routes. Independent gives the complete qualification with defined academic support. Guided adds a teacher and a timetabled seminar cohort. Tutored adds individual tutorials and a named adviser. Executive delivers the qualification to senior professionals in a small closed cohort, taught by senior academics and scheduled around their calendars. Bespoke builds the programme around one person.

The College opens in the Gulf in the autumn of 2027, in the United Kingdom and Europe in 2028 and in Asia in 2030. In West Africa it works through institutions that buy places for their people, because every route costs more to deliver than individual learners there pay for English tuition. Employers buy places on the Tutored route from 2028.

WHAT IT NEEDS AND WHAT IT RETURNS

The College needs \$6.03M of founding capital, released in three tranches, each against a decision of the Board: \$1.52M to establish the institution in 2027; \$2.56M when it is ready to teach its first intake; and \$1.95M in 2029, once a full year of teaching, assessment and conferral has been completed and reviewed. Its cash is lowest in Spring 2031. It earns its first surplus in 2031, holds enough cash to return the founding capital in 2035, and ends its tenth year with the capital returnable and six months of operating cost in reserve.

Every figure in this plan comes from one model, built up from what the College promises each learner. The model counts the academic work each route requires, the staff that work needs and when they must be hired, what the platform, premises and assurance cost, what it costs to find each learner and what the fees bring in, term by term for ten years. The fee of each route is then built from that cost.

The five routes

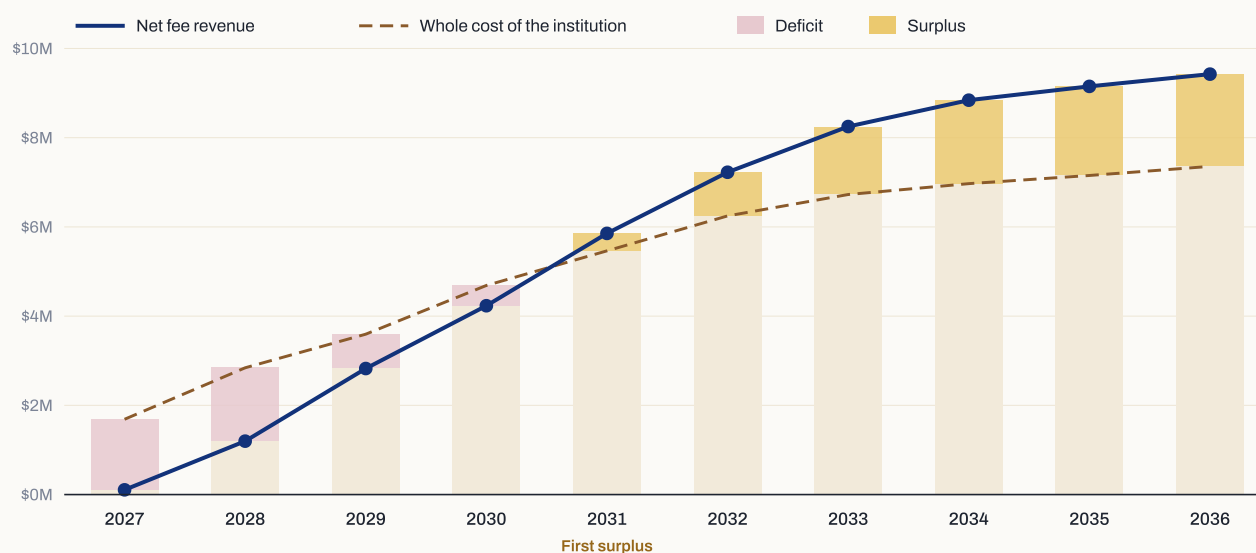
Every route leads to the same qualification, assessed the same way. Level fees at 2027 prices; a pathway is all six levels.

ROUTE	FOR	WHAT THE LEARNER RECEIVES	LEVEL FEE	SIX LEVELS
Independent	The academically capable, self-directed learner who wants the qualification and will study on their own schedule.	The complete qualification: curriculum, learning environment, assessment, examination, second marking, moderation, conferral, registry and verification, with defined academic support.	\$2,700	\$16,200
Guided	The learner who wants to study with others, to a timetable, with a teacher setting the pace.	Everything in Independent, and structured teaching in a scheduled seminar cohort, academic guidance, monitored progress and written feedback on every assignment beyond the mark.	\$3,000	\$18,000
Tutored	The learner who wants individual academic attention: a named adviser, personal feedback and tutorials.	Everything in Guided, in a smaller seminar cohort, with individual tutorials, a named academic adviser, personalised feedback and a structured progress review at every level.	\$3,950	\$23,700
Executive	The senior professional whose English must carry authority, and whose calendar cannot follow a published timetable.	The qualification delivered as an executive educational service: a closed professional cohort, senior academic staff, private scheduling, individual academic planning, the English of leadership, and high-touch administration and priority support.	\$6,650	\$39,900
Bespoke	The individual whose professional field, schedule and purpose need a programme built around them alone.	The qualification delivered one to one by senior academic staff, with material written to the holder's own professional domain, entirely private scheduling, and dedicated administration.	\$11,750	\$70,500

A learner pays for each level when it begins, never in advance of teaching, and may withdraw within fourteen days for a full refund. Fees rise three per cent a year. Employers buying ten or more places pay 15% less; institutions buying places at scale pay 20% less.

The decade: fees against the whole cost of the institution

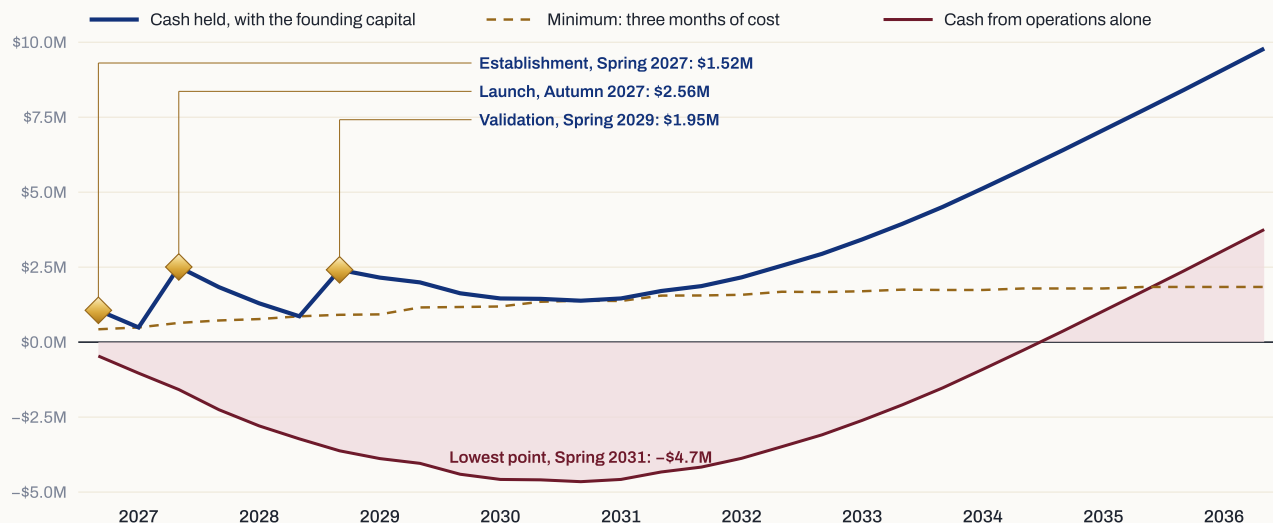
Net fee revenue and total cost each year, US dollars in the money of each year



Costs run ahead of fees for four years while the College builds its curriculum, its staff and its markets. Fees overtake costs in 2031; by 2036 the College takes \$9.4M in fees against \$7.4M of cost.

Cash, the founding capital and the gates

Cash at the end of each term, with the founding capital drawn at its gates, against the minimum the College must hold



Without the founding capital, the College's cash would fall to -\$4.7M in Spring 2031. The capital is sized so that the balance never falls below three months of the cost of the term ahead, and it is drawn in three tranches so that no founder funds a phase before the Board has decided the College has earned it.

The three tranches

GATE	RELEASED	CONDITION THE BOARD MUST CONFIRM	AMOUNT
Establishment	Spring 2027	The founding capital is committed and the Board constituted	\$1.52M
Launch	Autumn 2027	Levels I to III authored and reviewed, the platform tested, the academic offices and the first instructors in post	\$2.56M
Validation	Spring 2029	A full year of teaching, assessment, moderation and conferral completed and reviewed by the External Examiner; continuation within five points of plan	\$1.95M
Founding capital			\$6.03M

When the plan is wrong

Each case re-runs the whole model at the published fees. Capital needed is the founding capital that case would require.

CASE	OUTCOME IN THE TENTH YEAR	CAPITAL NEEDED	CAPITAL RETURNABLE
The plan as set out	Capital returnable, reserve at target	\$6.0M	2035
Enrolment twenty per cent lower	Capital not returnable by 2036	\$7.1M	2038
Continuation ten points lower	Capital returnable, reserve drawn	\$6.4M	2036
Acquisition a quarter dearer	Capital not returnable by 2036	\$6.9M	2037
Acquisition at the benchmark averages	Capital not returnable by 2036	\$10.4M	After 2046
Academic pay fifteen per cent higher	Capital not returnable by 2036	\$7.2M	2037
Executive demand half the plan	Capital returnable, reserve drawn	\$5.9M	2035
Institutional agreements a year late	Capital returnable, reserve drawn	\$6.0M	2035
Gulf launch two terms late	Capital returnable, reserve drawn	\$6.2M	2035
Technology fifty per cent dearer	Capital returnable, reserve drawn	\$6.1M	2035
The pound ten per cent stronger	Capital not returnable by 2036	\$7.5M	2037
Demand sensitive to price	Capital returnable, reserve drawn	\$6.6M	2036
Second tranche of capital two terms late	Capital returnable, reserve at target	\$6.0M	2035
A slow start	Capital not returnable by 2036	\$8.2M	2045
A thinner premium market	Capital returnable, reserve drawn	\$6.4M	2036
Partners slower than planned	Capital not returnable by 2036	\$6.5M	2037

The plan is most exposed to what a learner costs to find, to the pay of the people who teach, and to the pound. If enquiries convert at the averages of the published benchmark rather than its medians, the College needs \$10.4M and cannot return its capital within the decade; the Validation gate exists to measure that cost before the third tranche is drawn. A slow start, with the Gulf late, conversion lower and acquisition dearer at once, needs \$2.2M more than the plan. That sum should be held available by the founders and not drawn.

WHAT THE BOARD IS ASKED TO DECIDE

- 1 To commit the founding capital of \$6.03M, released in three tranches against the Establishment, Launch and Validation gates, and to hold a further \$2.20M available and undrawn against a slow start.
- 2 To adopt the five routes and their fees at 2027 prices, indexed each year to the pay of the people who deliver them.
- 3 To adopt the order in which the College enters its markets, and the rule that no market is funded beyond the point at which its last dollar of acquisition is repaid within a learner's first level.
- 4 To adopt the cash policy: never less than three months of operating cost in hand, and a reserve built to six months by 2036.
- 5 To decide the form of the founding capital, whether equity, loan, grant or a combination, which this plan leaves to the founders and the Board.
- 6 To adopt a Board gate for each year of the plan (Stage VII) and the measures on which each is judged (Stage VIII).

HOW TO READ THIS PLAN

Stages I to V describe the institution: its doctrine, its academic architecture, its markets, its products and prices, and the people and systems that deliver them. Stage VI is the financial model; Stage VII the ten years, one at a time; Stage VIII governance; Stage IX the investment case. The appendices hold the basis of the plan, every assumption with its source, and the model term by term.

Institutional doctrine

What the College is, the standard it keeps whatever a learner pays, and the rules it runs by. Everything later in the plan follows from these pages.

11	What the College is
11	One standard

12	The rules the College runs by
12	An institution built from nothing

1.1

What the College is

WorldWide English College, London Campus, will be an independent institution that teaches English to adults online and awards its own qualification.

The College will be incorporated in England and governed by a Board of Governors of 5 independent members, meeting four times a year. Its leadership, registry and administration will work from a serviced office in central London. Its teaching staff will teach online, from wherever in the United Kingdom they are recruited, to learners in the Gulf, the United Kingdom and Europe, Asia and, through institutions, West Africa.

It will award its own qualification. When it opens it will hold no accreditation, recognition or partnership, and it will claim none. The plan budgets for an application to the British Accreditation Council for accreditation of the College's online provision in 2030, once three years of teaching can be inspected. Whether to accredit is that body's decision.

1.2

One standard

The College's first commitment is that its qualification means the same thing whoever holds it. Every route carries the whole of the assessment: ten assignments at every level, each read and marked by a person; an examination with a written and a spoken paper; every script marked by two examiners and every disagreement reconciled; a sample of every level moderated each term; papers written afresh each year; and results confirmed by an Examination Board and reviewed by External Examiners from outside the College.

None of that is sold separately, and none of it is reduced on a cheaper route. What the routes sell is support: seminars, feedback, tutorials, advising, oversight and scheduling. The College never sells a higher mark, a faster award or an easier examination.

1.3

The rules the College runs by

- ◆ **A route is defined by what the learner receives.** No fee is quoted by the hour, and no page of this plan divides a fee by a number of hours. Hours appear only where the College must staff a commitment it has made.
- ◆ **One price worldwide.** A route costs the same wherever the learner lives. Where a market cannot pay for a route, the College reaches it through institutions that fund places on the published terms, not through a cheaper fee.
- ◆ **Fees are billed level by level, at the start of each level.** The College never holds a learner's money for teaching that has not begun, and refunds in full a level withdrawn within fourteen days.
- ◆ **No learner is taught a level that has not been written.** The curriculum is authored before it is taught, and a learner is placed only at a level that exists.
- ◆ **Teaching staff are hired a term before the learners who need them.** When the College cannot recruit fast enough, it admits fewer learners rather than break a promise to those it has.
- ◆ **Capital is released against decisions, not dates.** Each tranche waits for the Board to confirm that the College has done what the previous tranche was for.
- ◆ **The College always holds three months of operating cost in cash,** and builds a reserve of six months by the end of the decade.
- ◆ **Offices are named; people are not.** No one is published as holding a post before they have been appointed to it.

1.4

An institution built from nothing

This plan assumes an institution that begins with nothing: no learners, no staff, no curriculum, no revenue and no reputation. It does not borrow a figure from any earlier document. Each number in it is either published external evidence, a specification the College sets for itself, or a planning judgement stated as one; Appendix A explains the three, and Appendix B lists every assumption with its source.

Where the plan relies on judgement rather than evidence, it says so in the register and treats the figure as the first thing the College must measure. The largest of those judgements are how quickly learners continue from one level to the next, how far a market can be pushed before each enquiry costs more, and how many learners choose each route. Each is tested in Stage VI.

Academic architecture

The qualification the College awards, the assessment every route carries, the academic work behind it, and how learners move through six levels.

14	The qualification	15	Written before it is taught
14	Assessment, counted as work	15	How learners move through the levels
15	The institution's own academic work		

2.1

The qualification

One qualification in 6 levels, from A1 to C2 on the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages. Each level is a qualification in its own right, and each is studied in one term.

Each level is 10 modules, each a unit of assessed study, studied across one four-month term of 12 teaching weeks; the remaining weeks of the term are given to examination, moderation and conferral. The College admits learners three times a year, in the Spring, Summer and Autumn terms, and a learner who completes a level may begin the next in the following term.

A new learner is placed at the level their placement assessment shows, not at the first level by default. Most will enter at A1 or A2; a few will enter at C1 or above. A learner leaves with the qualification of every level they complete, and the College keeps the record of each award, and verifies it on request, for as long as it exists.

2.2

Assessment, counted as work

At every level, on every route, a learner submits 10 assignments and sits 1 examination with a written and a spoken paper. Every assignment and every paper is marked by one examiner and marked again by a second; where the two differ materially – the plan assumes 12% of scripts – a third reading reconciles them. The written paper is invigilated, one invigilator to 25 candidates, and 8% of candidates are expected to resit.

The table counts that commitment as the academic hours the College must staff for one learner at each level. The hours rise with the level because a C2 essay takes longer to read well than an A1 exercise. They are the same on every route, and they are the part of the cost of a fee the College could not reduce without changing the award.

The assessment of one learner, in academic hours

First-marking time for one script at each level, and the hours of assessment work per learner per level once second marking, reconciliation, invigilation and resits are counted

LEVEL	ASSIGNMENT	WRITTEN PAPER	SPOKEN PAPER	ASSIGNMENTS, H	EXAMINATION, H	RESITS, H	TOTAL, H
Level I · A1	10 min	25 min	12 min	3.5	1.4	0.11	5.0
Level II · A2	12 min	30 min	14 min	4.1	1.7	0.13	5.9
Level III · B1	15 min	35 min	16 min	5.2	1.9	0.15	7.2
Level IV · B2	18 min	40 min	18 min	6.2	2.1	0.17	8.5
Level V · C1	22 min	45 min	20 min	7.6	2.4	0.19	10.2
Level VI · C2	26 min	50 min	22 min	9.0	2.6	0.21	11.8

2.3 The institution’s own academic work

Some academic work belongs to no single learner. It is carried by the academic establishment and counted in the plan as its own line of hours, term by term:

- ◆ **Moderation:** 5 hours at each level taught each term, reviewing a 10% sample of marked work.
- ◆ **The Examination Board:** 12 hours a term to confirm results before they are released.
- ◆ **Examination papers:** 3 new versions of the paper at each level every year, 30 hours each to write and review.
- ◆ **Curriculum maintenance:** 8 hours a module each year once a level is taught.
- ◆ **Quality review:** 160 hours a year across the institution.
- ◆ **External Examiners:** 3 appointed from outside the College, one for each pair of levels, reporting to the Board each year.

2.4 Written before it is taught

Each module takes 70 hours of academic time to write, set and review: 700 hours a level. The first three levels are written across the two terms before the College opens; each further level is written in the term before it is first taught. The schedule sets when the College can teach each level, and the model will not place a learner at a level that does not yet exist.

The curriculum schedule

LEVEL	WRITTEN IN	FIRST TAUGHT	ACADEMIC HOURS TO WRITE
Level I · A1	Spring 2027 and Summer 2027	Autumn 2027	700
Level II · A2	Spring 2027 and Summer 2027	Autumn 2027	700
Level III · B1	Spring 2027 and Summer 2027	Autumn 2027	700
Level IV · B2	Autumn 2027	Spring 2028	700
Level V · C1	Spring 2028	Summer 2028	700
Level VI · C2	Summer 2028	Autumn 2028	700

2.5 How learners move through the levels

Of those who begin a level, a share complete it; of those who complete it, a share begin the next level in the following term. Both rates rise with the level, because a learner who has reached B2 has already shown a commitment an A1 entrant has not. On these rates a new learner can expect to study 2.6 levels with the College.

Placement, completion and continuation

The plan’s planning judgements; the first quantities the College replaces with its own measurement

LEVEL	NEW LEARNERS PLACED HERE	COMPLETE THE LEVEL	GO ON TO THE NEXT
Level I · A1	34%	83%	74%
Level II · A2	26%	86%	78%
Level III · B1	20%	88%	81%
Level IV · B2	12%	89%	84%
Level V · C1	6%	90%	87%
Level VI · C2	2%	91%	—

WHAT THE BOARD SHOULD WATCH

Continuation is among the quantities the plan is most sensitive to. Ten points lower at every level leaves the College holding \$0.6M at the end of 2036 against a reserve target of \$3.7M (Stage VI). It is reported to the Board every term, level by level.

Market architecture

Where the College recruits and in what order, what each market already pays for English, what it costs to find a learner, and the two channels that buy places in blocks.

18	Four markets, in order	20	What a learner costs to find
19	What each market already pays	21	Employers and institutions

3.1

Four markets, in order

The College enters its markets one at a time, each once the one before has shown what a learner costs to find there.

Demand in this plan is driven by what the College decides to spend on finding learners, not by an assumed share of a population. The acquisition budget in each market is a decision of the plan; what an enquiry costs is evidence; and how many enquiries become enrolments follows the College’s own admissions passage from enquiry to application, placement, offer and enrolment.

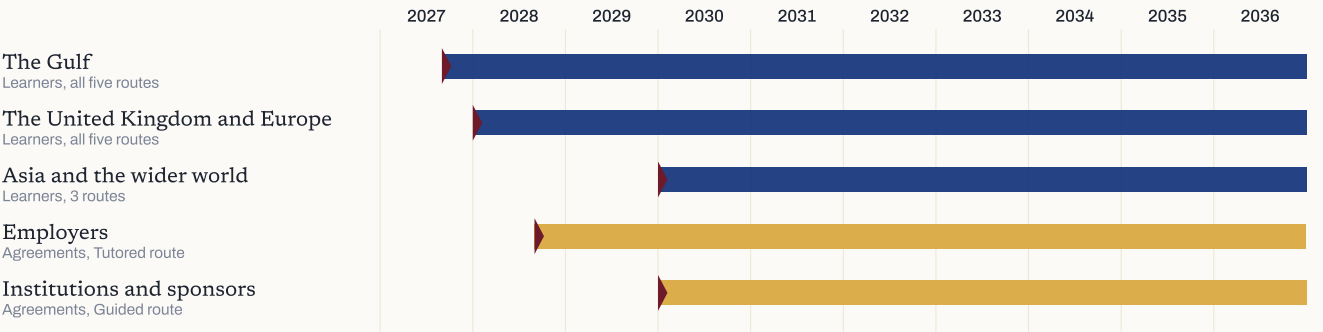
The markets

MARKET	OPENS	ROUTES SOLD	BUDGET A YEAR	WHY, AND WHY THEN
The Gulf	Autumn 2027	All five	\$367k	The market the College opens first. Employer and family sponsorship of study is common, the British Council publishes a certificated, levelled adult English programme there, and the College's executive route is written for its professional demand.
The United Kingdom and Europe	Spring 2028	All five	\$245k	The College's home market, opened second, where a London institution is read directly and university pre-session English sets the price of intensive, assessed study.
West Africa	Spring 2030	Through institutions only	—	Published prices for English tuition in Nigeria are a small fraction of what any route costs to deliver: an IELTS course in Lagos is advertised at NGN 75,000 a month. The College does not sell there more cheaply; it reaches West African learners through institutions, ministries and foundations that fund places on the published terms.
Asia and the wider world	Spring 2030	Independent, Guided, Tutored	\$133k	Opened last, deliberately. The plan holds no published price evidence for the region and will not spend to be known in a market it has not studied; it opens once three years of recruitment elsewhere have measured what a learner costs to reach.

The budget is the most the plan spends in a market in any year, at 2027 prices, reached step by step from its opening and held at its last step thereafter.

When each market and channel opens

Learners recruited directly in sapphire; places bought under agreement in gold



3.2

What each market already pays

Published prices for English study, read from the providers' own pages, show what a learner in each market already pays. None is the College's product: a course sells tuition, and the College's fee buys a qualification with every level examined, every script marked twice and the record kept for good. They show where the College's fees stand.

Published prices in the College's markets

Researched on 19 September 2026; sources in Appendix B

MARKET	PROVIDER	WHAT IT SELLS	PUBLISHED PRICE	IN DOLLARS
The Gulf	British Council, Saudi Arabia	Adult English, 40 credits over four months, 60 contact hours	SAR 6,037.50 incl. VAT	\$1,610
The Gulf	British Council, Saudi Arabia	Adult English, 60 credits over six months, 90 contact hours	SAR 7,992.50 incl. VAT	\$2,131
The Gulf	British Council, United Arab Emirates	IELTS preparation course, 24 hours	AED 2,950	\$803
The United Kingdom and Europe	University of Chester	Pre-sessional English, 13 weeks	£3,350	\$4,495
The United Kingdom and Europe	University of Stirling	Pre-sessional English, 8 weeks, online	£5,150	\$6,910
The United Kingdom and Europe	University of Oxford Language Centre	Pre-sessional Academic English, 6 weeks	£3,250	\$4,361
West Africa	PEI Centre, Lagos	IELTS training, one month	NGN 75,000	\$49

In the Gulf the British Council sells a four-month adult English course in Saudi Arabia for \$1,610, with 60 contact hours. The College's Guided level, also four months, costs \$3,000: 24 hours of seminar teaching in a cohort of no more than 14, written feedback on every assignment, and an examined qualification with every script marked twice. The College asks a Gulf learner to pay about 86% more for fewer hours in a room and a heavier assessment behind the award. Whether enough learners will is the plan's central commercial question, and the Validation gate answers it from the College's own enrolments before the third tranche is drawn.

In the United Kingdom the nearest assessed comparison is university pre-sessional English, which is intensive and full-time and costs between 1.4 and 3.5 times as much a week as a Guided level taken over its 12 teaching weeks. In Nigeria a month of IELTS tuition in Lagos is advertised at \$49. That is why the College does not sell there directly, and reaches West African learners through institutions and sponsors instead.

3.3

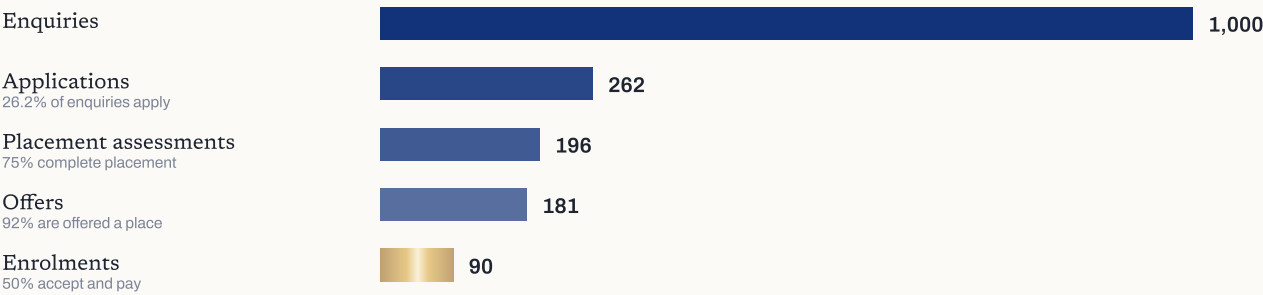
What a learner costs to find

No published figure for the cost of an enquiry in the Gulf or the United Kingdom survived verification. The plan therefore uses the one well-documented benchmark for professional, continuing and online programmes, the UPCEA and Search Influence study: a median cost of \$106 an enquiry and \$1,173 an enrolled student, which implies that about 9.0% of enquiries enrol. It applies the benchmark in every market rather than assume any is cheaper, and the College’s first campaigns replace it.

A market does not absorb spending without limit. Past a reference level of spend, each further enquiry costs more: doubling spend beyond it raises the cost of each enquiry by about 23%. That is the plan’s principal demand judgement, and it sets a ceiling on each market’s budget. The ceiling is the spend at which the last dollar is still repaid within the learner’s first level, and no market is planned past it.

From a thousand enquiries to enrolled learners

The admissions passage, at the rates the plan assumes



What a learner costs to find, and when the College has it back

Over the decade, at the budgets planned. A level’s contribution is its fee less the route’s own teaching and assessment and the cost of collecting it, at 2027 prices, across the market’s mix of routes.

MARKET	BUDGET	PER ENQUIRY	ENROL	PER ENROLMENT	A LEVEL CONTRIBUTES	REPAID WITHIN	CEILING
The Gulf	\$367k	\$135	9.0%	\$1,494	\$2,364	0.63 of a level	\$451k
The United Kingdom and Europe	\$245k	\$129	9.0%	\$1,430	\$2,212	0.65 of a level	\$289k
Asia and the wider world	\$133k	\$122	9.0%	\$1,353	\$2,067	0.65 of a level	\$154k

A new learner studies 2.6 levels on average, so each enrolment returns several times what it cost to find. The limit on the College’s growth is not what a learner costs; it is how far each market can be pushed and the capital needed to teach the learners it brings.

3.4 Employers and institutions

Two channels sell places in blocks, under agreement. An employer buys places on the Tutored route for its own staff; a ministry, university, foundation or federation buys places at scale on the Guided route under a public or charitable mandate. These are the only fees the College discounts, and the discount is the price of a guaranteed block of places. Agreements are invoiced each term and paid on the buyer’s terms, and the plan carries what they owe until it is paid.

The agreement channels

CHANNEL	ROUTE	DISCOUNT	PLACES	A YEAR	COST TO WIN	PAID IN	SIGNED IN
Employers	Tutored	15%	10	12	\$6,000	45 days	The Gulf 60%; The United Kingdom and Europe 40%
Institutions and sponsors	Guided	20%	60	4	\$25,000	90 days	West Africa 50%; Asia and the wider world 30%; The Gulf 20%

“A year” is the number of agreements signed a year once the channel is at full strength. The cost to win is travel, proposals and negotiation beyond the partnerships team’s own salaries.

Commercial architecture

The five routes as defined products, how each fee is built from the cost of delivering it, the margin the plan solves for, and what scale does to price.

23	Five routes, one qualification
24	How a fee is built
25	The margin is solved, not chosen

25	Scale and price
25	The financial constitution
26	Collecting the fee

4.1 Five routes, one qualification

Each route is a defined educational product: a stated list of what the learner receives, each item with the work that delivers it. The qualification at the end is the same.

What each route provides

The service specification, per learner at each level. Every route also carries the whole of the assessment in Stage II.

PER LEARNER, PER LEVEL	INDEPENDENT	GUIDED	TUTORED	EXECUTIVE	BESPOKE
Assessment and the qualification	Identical on every route: ten person-marked assignments, a written and a spoken examination, every script marked twice, moderation, the Examination Board and the record of the award				
Seminar teaching, hours a level	—	24	24	24	—
Largest seminar cohort	—	14	10	6	—
Leadership strand, hours a level	—	—	—	8	—
Individual tutorials, hours a level	—	—	8	12	40
Written feedback on each assignment	—	6 min	12 min	15 min	20 min
Adviser, review and monitoring, hours	0.5	1	2.5	2	3
Senior academic oversight, hours	—	—	—	2	3
Material written for the learner, hours	—	—	—	—	15
Dedicated administration, hours	—	—	—	3	5
Taught by	Instructors	Instructors	Instructors	Senior academics	Senior academics
Scheduling	The learner's own	Timetabled	Timetabled	Private	Private

The specification is what the College must staff. A Guided learner is promised twenty-four hours of seminar teaching at each level in a cohort of no more than fourteen; the College therefore counts seminar sections from the learners actually present each term, and hires the instructors those sections need. An Executive learner is taught by a senior academic, in a cohort of six, at times that suit the learner; the College therefore counts a senior grade and a lower share of each academic’s time available for teaching, because time held open around a learner’s calendar cannot be timetabled.

4.2

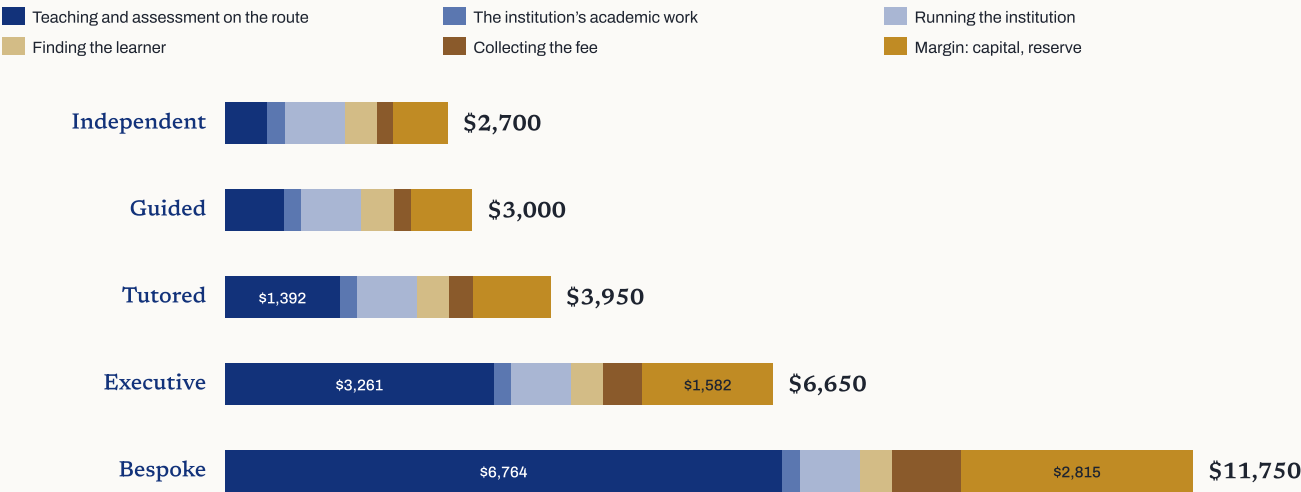
How a fee is built

Each fee is built up from the whole cost of the institution at the volume the plan reaches at maturity, 2034, and restated at 2027 prices. It has six parts. The first is the route’s own teaching and assessment: its seminars at the cohort sizes the plan actually fills, its tutorials, feedback and advising, and the assessment every route carries. The next three are shared equally by every level any learner studies: the institution’s own academic work, from moderation to academic management; the cost of running the institution, from its professional staff to its platform, premises and governance; and the cost of finding learners. The fifth is the cost of collecting the fee and of refunds. The last is the margin.

The shared costs fall on every route alike because every learner uses them alike: each is admitted, registered, examined, recorded and supported by the same institution. The routes differ only in what they add, which is why the fees rise with what each route provides.

The anatomy of a level fee

What each part of a level fee pays for, at 2027 prices



The fee build-up

One level, 2027 prices

ROUTE	ROUTE'S TEACHING	ACADEMIC WORK	RUNNING	FINDING	COLLECTING	MARGIN	LEVEL FEE	SIX LEVELS
Independent	\$513	\$214	\$729	\$390	\$192	\$661	\$2,700	\$16,200
Guided	\$716	\$214	\$729	\$390	\$214	\$737	\$3,000	\$18,000
Tutored	\$1,392	\$214	\$729	\$390	\$282	\$943	\$3,950	\$23,700
Executive	\$3,261	\$214	\$729	\$390	\$474	\$1,582	\$6,650	\$39,900
Bespoke	\$6,764	\$214	\$729	\$390	\$838	\$2,815	\$11,750	\$70,500

4.3

The margin is solved, not chosen

The margin is the one part of a fee that is not a cost, and the plan does not choose it. It solves for it. The margin is the smallest share of each fee at which the ten-year plan, run in full, ends 2036 holding enough cash to return every dollar of founding capital and still hold six months of operating cost in reserve. At 24.0% the plan passes that test; a margin one point lower fails it. What the margin pays for is the founding capital and the reserve, and nothing else.

24.0% MARGIN The smallest that returns the capital and completes the reserve	\$1,333 SHARED COST OF A LEVEL At 2027 prices and 2034 volume	7.1% COLLECTION AND REFUNDS A share of every retail fee
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4.4

Scale and price

The shared costs of the institution are spread over the learners it teaches, so the fee each route needs depends on how large the College becomes. The table resolves the whole plan for markets half as large again and twice as large, with every other assumption unchanged.

What scale does to price and to capital

Learners studying in 2036; shared cost and fees for one level at 2027 prices

CASE	LEARNERS	SHARED COST	INDEPENDENT	GUIDED	TUTORED	EXECUTIVE	BESPOKE	CAPITAL
The plan	740	\$1,333	\$2,700	\$3,000	\$3,950	\$6,650	\$11,750	\$6.0M
Markets half as large again	1,110	\$1,119	\$2,300	\$2,600	\$3,550	\$6,000	\$11,100	\$6.8M
Markets twice as large	1,480	\$1,014	\$2,150	\$2,400	\$3,350	\$5,750	\$10,850	\$7.5M

Twice the plan’s volume would lower the Guided fee from \$3,000 to \$2,400 and need \$1.4M more capital. The plan is sized on its own judgement of how large each market is, which is the demand assumption it can least evidence before it recruits. If the first two years show the Gulf and the United Kingdom are larger than the plan assumes, the Board has a clear choice between lower fees and a higher return, and this table is its starting point.

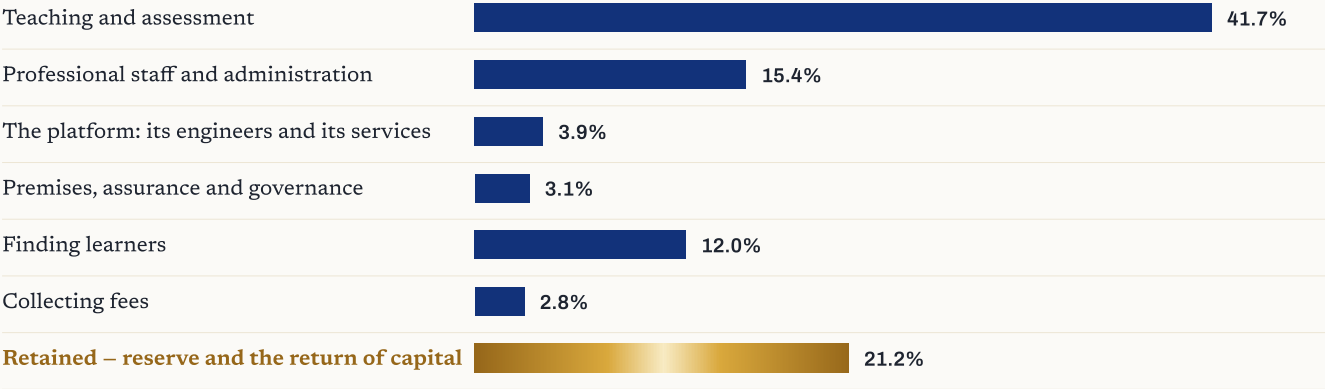
4.5

The financial constitution

How each dollar of fee income is spent is not set by rule in this plan. It is read from the model once the College has reached the volume its fees were built on. In 2034 the model spends the College’s net fee income as follows.

Where each dollar goes, 2034

Shares of net fee revenue



Teaching and assessment take 42% of every dollar. The College retains 21%, which is what returns the founding capital and builds the reserve. If the College’s costs or fees move, these shares move with them; they are a result the Board monitors, not a limit it enforces.

4.6 Collecting the fee

Learners pay by card or bank transfer; the plan assumes 85% pay by card. Card fees are charged at the published rates of the College’s payment processor, by where the card was issued, and every card payment carries a further charge for conversion, because fees are set in dollars and the College settles in pounds. Agreements are invoiced and paid by transfer. Across the pricing year, collection costs 4.1% of retail fees, and refunds in the fourteen-day window a further 3%.

Card processing

Stripe, United Kingdom, as published on 23 September 2026; each payment also carries a fixed 20p

CARD	RATE
Standard UK cards	1.50%
Premium UK cards	2.80%
Cards issued in the EEA	2.50%
Cards issued elsewhere	3.15%
Currency conversion, added to every card payment	2.00%

Operating model

How the work each route promises becomes the people the College employs and when it hires them, what they cost, and the platform, premises and assurance the institution runs on.

28	From work to people	30	The platform
28	The establishment	31	Premises, assurance and governance
30	Pay and its costs		

5.1

From work to people

The College does not decide how many teachers it employs. It counts the academic work its routes promise, term by term, and employs the people that work needs.

A full-time academic is contracted for 1,650 hours a year, thirty-seven and a half hours a week across forty-four weeks. Of that, the plan assumes 72% is spent teaching, marking, tutoring and advising, and the rest on preparation, standardisation and professional development: 1,188 productive hours a year. An academic held available around executive learners’ own calendars cannot be timetabled as tightly, and gives 58%: 957 hours.

Each term the model adds up the hours of assessment, seminars, tutorials, feedback and advising that the learners present require, adds the institution’s own academic work, divides by the productive hours of one academic, and rounds up to whole people. It hires them a term before they are needed. It can always recruit three academics in a term and, beyond that, can grow the academic staff by no more than a third in a term; when the work would outrun that, it admits fewer new learners rather than teach the ones it has less well. In the plan as set out, that never happens.

£44,789 AN INSTRUCTOR’S SALARY, 2027 The survey’s April 2025 median, carried forward at 3% a year	\$71,106 THEIR WHOLE COST TO THE COLLEGE With employer’s National Insurance and pension, in dollars	\$60 THE COST OF AN ACADEMIC HOUR \$93 for a senior academic held on private schedule
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The cost of an academic hour is how the plan costs the work a route promises. It is not a price: the College sells no hours, and no fee in this plan is a number of hours multiplied by a rate.

5.2

The establishment

Two kinds of post make up the professional establishment. Standing posts exist because the institution exists and are filled on a date whatever the enrolment. Scaling posts are created by a threshold, such as the number of learners studying or of new learners each term, and are always filled by whole people, a term before the work that needs them arrives. Salaries are the Office for National Statistics’ April 2025 figures: national figures for the academics, who teach online from anywhere in the United Kingdom, and London figures for the establishment, which works from London.

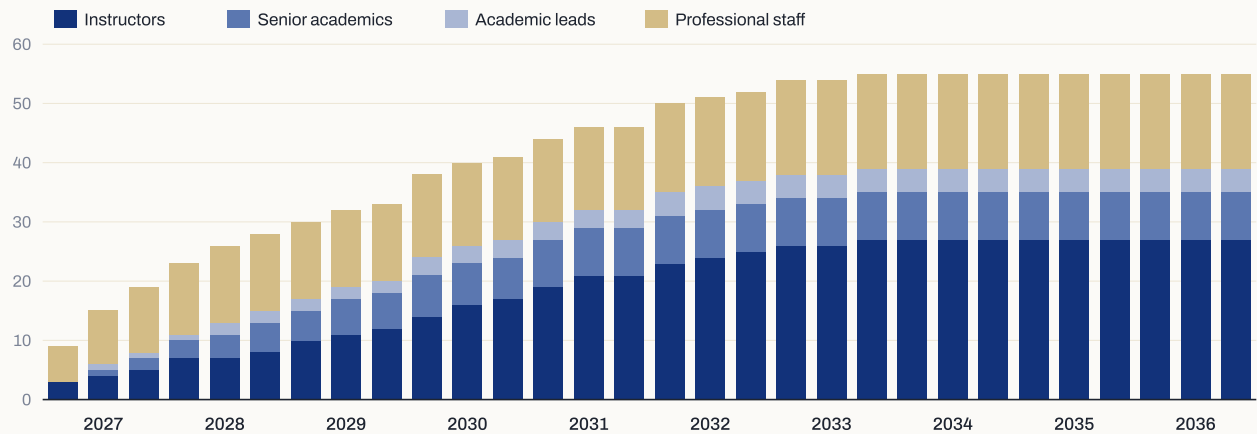
Every post, what creates it and what it is paid

Salaries as surveyed, April 2025; the plan carries them forward 3% a year

OFFICE	CREATED	SALARY	SALARY BASIS	2036
ACADEMIC STAFF, DERIVED EACH TERM FROM THE WORK				
Instructor	As many as the standard routes' teaching and assessment need, hired a term ahead	£42,218	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2312, UK median	27
Senior academic	As many as the Executive and Bespoke routes need	£52,835	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2311, UK median	8
Academic lead	One for every 10 academics	£52,835	Paid as a senior academic	4
THE PROFESSIONAL ESTABLISHMENT				
Principal and Chief Executive	From Spring 2027	£83,623	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2321, UK upper quartile	1
Director of Academic Standards	From Spring 2027	£59,897	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2322, UK upper quartile	1
Registrar	From Spring 2027	£49,031	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2322, London median	1
Head of Finance	From Spring 2027	£61,549	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 3534, London median	1
Platform Engineer	From Spring 2027; at least 2, then one for every 2,000 learners studying	£75,296	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2134, London median	2
Head of Marketing and Admissions	From Summer 2027	£60,658	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2432, London median	1
Admissions Officer	From Summer 2027; at least 1, then one for every 250 new learners a term	£33,939	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 4159, London median	2
Learner Services Officer	From Autumn 2027; at least 1, then one for every 350 learners studying	£33,730	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 3229, London median	3
Examinations Officer	From Autumn 2027; at least 1, then one for every 1,200 learners studying	£33,939	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 4159, London median	1
Quality and Compliance Officer	From Spring 2028	£46,581	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2322, UK median	1
Head of Institutional Partnerships	A term before the first agreement is signed	£60,658	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 2432, London median	1
Executive Programmes Coordinator	A term before the first Executive learner; then one for every 1,100 hours of executive administration a year	£33,939	ONS ASHE 2025, SOC 4159, London median	1
Staff at the end of 2036				55

The establishment, term by term

People employed at the end of each term



5.3 Pay and its costs

What employing a person costs beyond their salary

COST	RATE	SOURCE
Employer's National Insurance	15% of pay above £5,000 a year	HMRC, rates for 2026 to 2027
Employment Allowance	Up to £10,500 a year off the employer's National Insurance	HMRC, rates for 2026 to 2027
Apprenticeship Levy	0.5% of the pay bill, less £15,000 a year; payable from 2032	HMRC, Pay Apprenticeship Levy
Workplace pension	5% of salary, above the statutory 3%	The College's own policy
Annual pay rise	3% a year across the establishment	Planning judgement
Recruitment	12% of first-year salary for each hire	Planning judgement

5.4 The platform

The College’s platform is its own: the learning environment, the assessment and recording workspace, the registry and its public verification, admissions and payments. The people who build and run it are on the establishment. What the College buys from others is priced from the vendors’ published pages and scales with the one thing that drives it.

The platform in 2036

Unit prices as published in September 2026, carried forward at 2% a year

LINE	WHAT IT IS	UNIT PRICE	US\$
Platform engineers	Build and run the College's own platform: learning, assessment, records, admissions and payments	2 on the establishment	\$334k
Application hosting and compute	Cloudflare Workers and the D1 database; requests and compute beyond the included allowance	\$5 a month, \$0.3 per million requests	\$0k
Recordings and submissions storage	Recorded spoken papers and submitted work, kept 6 years	\$0.015 per GB-month	\$2k
Transactional email	Enrolment, schedule, results and conferral notices	Resend, by monthly volume	\$0k
Live classroom licences	One licence for every academic who teaches	\$14.16 a licence a month	\$7k
Staff productivity suite	Email, calendar and documents for every member of staff	\$12 a user a month	\$10k
Independent security testing	An independent penetration test of the platform every year	£6,250 a year	\$10k
Perpetual registry and verification	The permanent record of every award, and its verification	\$0.05 a holder a year	\$0k
The platform			\$364k

5.5 Premises, assurance and governance

Running the institution in 2036

LINE	WHAT IT PAYS FOR	US\$
Premises	A serviced office in central London, one desk for every two professional staff, at £640 a desk a month; and a registered office	\$126k
Insurance	Professional indemnity, public and employers' liability, cyber and directors' cover	\$30k
Audit, accounts and registration	A voluntary independent audit priced by turnover; accounting system and payroll; year-end accounts and tax; data protection and Companies House fees	\$47k
Legal	Contracts, agreements with institutions, employment and data protection advice	\$24k
External Examiners	3 examiners at £600 a year each, and a supplement for the Chief External Examiner	\$3k
Board of Governors	5 independent governors, an honorarium and expenses for four meetings a year	\$37k
Accreditation	British Accreditation Council: application and inspection in 2030, an interim inspection a year later, re-inspection every 4 years and an annual fee	\$3k
Premises, assurance and governance		\$270k

At the scale of this plan the College is exempt from statutory audit; it is audited from its second year because founders and a Board require audited accounts.

Financial model

The basis of every number in the plan, the ten-year statement, where the income comes from, the cash and the capital it needs, and what happens when the plan is wrong.

33	The basis of the financial plan	35	Cash and capital
34	The ten-year statement	37	When the plan is wrong
35	Where the income comes from		

6.1

The basis of the financial plan

This section says once what the numbers in this plan are and where they come from, so that no page needs to say it again.

The financial plan is one model, run term by term for the thirty terms from Spring 2027 to Autumn 2036. It begins with what the College decides to spend on finding learners and follows each consequence in order: enquiries, enrolments, learners at each level, the academic work their routes require, the people that work needs, and what those people, the platform, the premises, acquisition and collection cost. Fees are recognised in the term they are taught. Years are the sum of their terms.

Every number the model uses is one of 202 stated assumptions, listed with its source in Appendix B. 70 are published external evidence, each naming the page it was read from and the date. 73 are specifications the College sets for itself, such as the number of assignments at each level or the size of a seminar cohort. 59 are planning judgements, such as how many learners continue from one level to the next. Those are the figures the College replaces first with its own measurement, and each is reported to the Board as that measurement arrives.

Fees are stated at 2027 prices and rise 3% a year with the pay of the people who deliver them. Salaries are the April 2025 survey figures, carried forward at the same rate. Every other price is as published or planned in 2026, carried forward at 2% a year. Sterling costs are converted at 1.3417 dollars to the pound.

The model is held by tests that run each time it changes: every term's costs reconcile to the dollar; every year is the sum of its terms; cash differs from surplus only by what institutions owe; no learner is taught a level before it is written; the staff always cover the work the routes promise; the fees rise with what each route provides; the margin is the smallest that passes the plan's own test; and no figure in the model comes from outside the plan's own record.

6.2 The ten-year statement

Learners, income, cost and cash, 2027 to 2036

US dollars in the money of each year, thousands; learners in whole numbers

	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032	2033	2034	2035	2036
LEARNERS										
New learners	26	174	325	479	640	761	838	858	858	858
Studying at the year's end	26	145	267	408	545	651	719	738	740	740
INCOME, US\$ THOUSANDS										
Fees from learners	109	1,234	2,605	3,663	4,692	5,423	5,837	6,046	6,227	6,414
Fees under agreement	0	0	308	701	1,343	2,026	2,668	3,069	3,207	3,303
Refunds	-3	-37	-87	-131	-181	-223	-255	-273	-283	-291
Net fee revenue	106	1,197	2,825	4,233	5,855	7,225	8,250	8,841	9,151	9,425
COST, US\$ THOUSANDS										
Teaching and assessment	433	1,058	1,557	2,195	2,736	3,226	3,522	3,687	3,799	3,914
Professional staff	598	921	985	1,077	1,111	1,211	1,317	1,359	1,401	1,444
Recruiting staff	166	78	40	65	43	51	24	0	0	0
The platform	264	278	288	299	310	321	332	343	353	364
Premises, assurance, governance	161	162	172	215	210	227	253	275	265	270
Finding learners	61	293	446	685	861	988	1,036	1,057	1,078	1,100
Collecting fees	5	52	107	150	193	223	241	250	257	265
Total cost	1,688	2,842	3,595	4,688	5,464	6,246	6,726	6,970	7,153	7,357
Surplus or deficit	-1,582	-1,645	-770	-455	391	979	1,524	1,871	1,998	2,068
Less growth in what institutions owe	0	0	-47	-95	-129	-136	-127	-56	-20	-18
Cash from operations	-1,582	-1,645	-817	-549	262	843	1,396	1,816	1,977	2,050
Cumulative, before capital	-1,582	-3,226	-4,043	-4,592	-4,330	-3,487	-2,090	-274	1,703	3,753

Professional staff excludes the platform engineers, who are shown with the platform. Cumulative cash is from operations alone; the founding capital is added in 6.4.

6.3 Where the income comes from

By route, 2036

Learners studying in an average term; gross fees for the year

ROUTE	LEARNERS	FEES	SHARE
Independent	103	\$1,094k	11%
Guided	368	\$3,840k	40%
Tutored	209	\$2,985k	31%
Executive	46	\$1,198k	12%
Bespoke	13	\$600k	6%

By market, 2036

Places bought under agreement are attributed to the markets where agreements are signed

MARKET	LEARNERS	OF WHOM UNDER AGREEMENT	FEES	SHARE
The Gulf	307	103	\$4,611k	47%
The United Kingdom and Europe	185	41	\$2,579k	27%
West Africa	103	103	\$972k	10%
Asia and the wider world	145	62	\$1,555k	16%

6.4 Cash and capital

The founding capital is a cash measure. It is the money the College must have so that in every term its balance stays at or above three months of the cost of the term ahead, however deep the early years run. On the plan as set out, that is \$6.03M. It is drawn in three tranches, each against a Board gate, and each covers the College until the next.

Because fees are billed level by level at the start of each level, the College never holds a learner's money for teaching not yet begun, and the cash it holds is its own. Institutions pay on their own terms, so what they owe at the end of a term is carried and counted: the plan's cash is its surplus less the growth in what institutions owe.

Cash, year by year

US dollars in the money of each year

YEAR	CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE	CAPITAL DRAWN	BALANCE AT YEAR END	MINIMUM
2027	-\$1,582k	-\$1,582k	\$4,087k	\$2,506k	\$641k
2028	-\$1,645k	-\$3,226k	—	\$861k	\$861k
2029	-\$817k	-\$4,043k	\$1,947k	\$1,992k	\$1,157k
2030	-\$549k	-\$4,592k	—	\$1,442k	\$1,345k
2031	\$262k	-\$4,330k	—	\$1,705k	\$1,552k
2032	\$843k	-\$3,487k	—	\$2,548k	\$1,679k
2033	\$1,396k	-\$2,090k	—	\$3,944k	\$1,750k
2034	\$1,816k	-\$274k	—	\$5,760k	\$1,788k
2035	\$1,977k	\$1,703k	—	\$7,737k	\$1,839k
2036	\$2,050k	\$3,753k	—	\$9,787k	\$1,839k

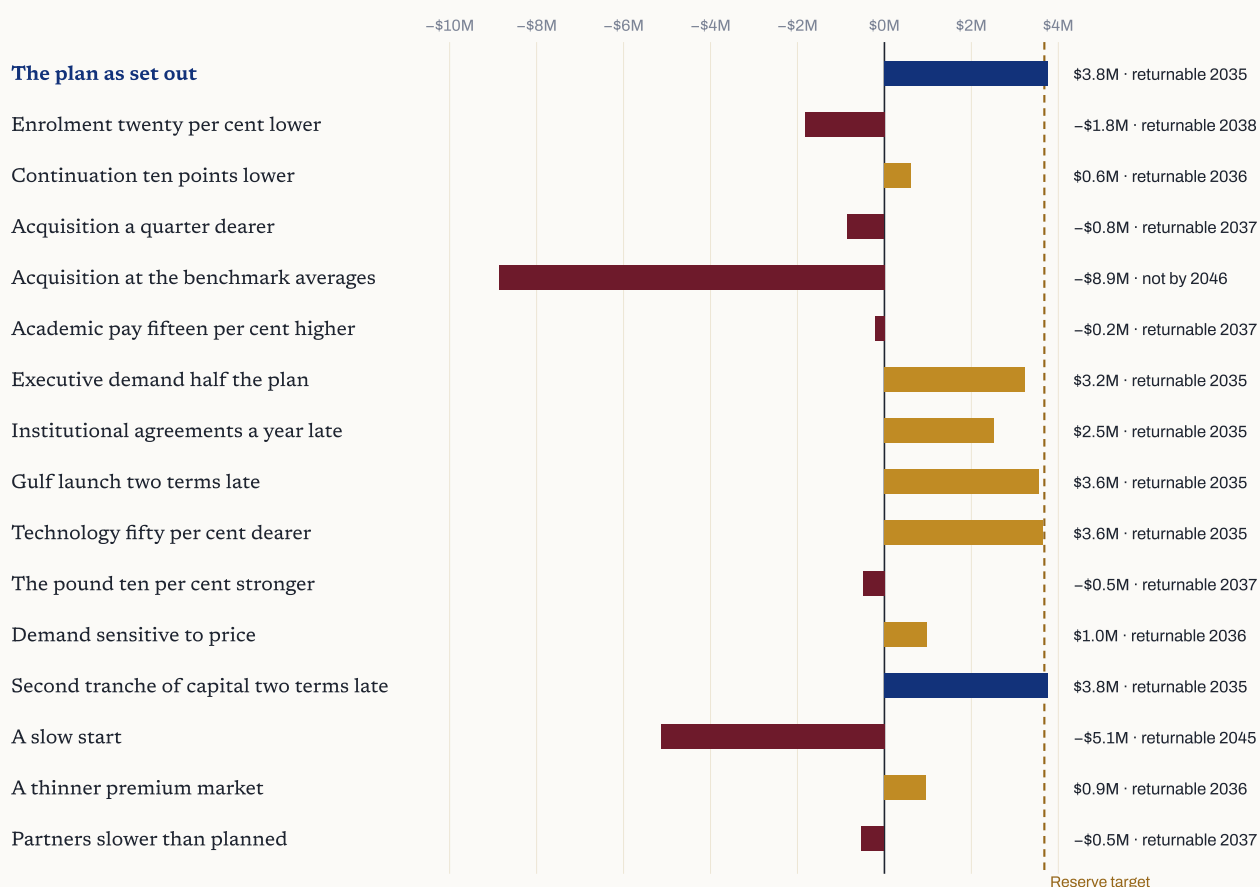
6.5

When the plan is wrong

Each case below changes one assumption, or several at once, and runs the whole model again at the published fees, because the College does not change its prices when a year goes badly. A shock changes what the College teaches, which changes whom it admits and the staff it needs, so none of these is a percentage applied to a finished total.

Cash held at the end of 2036, case by case

Before the founding capital is returned. Sapphire: capital returnable with the reserve at target; gold: returnable with the reserve drawn; crimson: not yet returnable.



The cases

CASE	WHAT CHANGES	CAPITAL NEEDED	CASH, END 2036	CAPITAL RETURNABLE
Enrolment twenty per cent lower	Every market converts a fifth fewer enquiries into enrolments, and every agreement fills a fifth fewer places	\$7.1M	-\$1.8M	2038
Continuation ten points lower	Ten percentage points fewer learners continue from each level to the next	\$6.4M	\$0.6M	2036
Acquisition a quarter dearer	Every enquiry costs a quarter more to generate	\$6.9M	-\$0.8M	2037

The cases – continued

CASE	WHAT CHANGES	CAPITAL NEEDED	CASH, END 2036	CAPITAL RETURNABLE
Acquisition at the benchmark averages	Enquiries cost the benchmark average of \$140 rather than the median of \$106, and convert at the 4.9% the averages imply rather than 9.0%	\$10.4M	–\$8.9M	After 2046
Academic pay fifteen per cent higher	The national market for qualified teachers of English tightens	\$7.2M	–\$0.2M	2037
Executive demand half the plan	Half of the executive and bespoke learners the plan expects take the Tutored route instead	\$5.9M	\$3.2M	2035
Institutional agreements a year late	Both agreement channels open a year later and ramp a year behind	\$6.0M	\$2.5M	2035
Gulf launch two terms late	The first market opens two terms behind plan	\$6.2M	\$3.6M	2035
Technology fifty per cent dearer	Every purchased technology line costs half as much again	\$6.1M	\$3.6M	2035
The pound ten per cent stronger	The College earns in dollars and pays in pounds; every sterling cost is ten per cent dearer in dollars for the whole decade	\$7.5M	–\$0.5M	2037
Demand sensitive to price	Enrolment falls by eight tenths of one per cent for each one per cent the tariff stands above the plan's reference	\$6.6M	\$1.0M	2036
Second tranche of capital two terms late	The capital needed to expand arrives two terms after the gate it was released against	\$6.0M	\$3.8M	2035
A slow start	The first market opens late, converts less well and costs more to reach – the case the founding capital must survive	\$8.2M	–\$5.1M	2045
A thinner premium market	The top of the market is smaller and more price-conscious than planned	\$6.4M	\$0.9M	2036
Partners slower than planned	The institutional channels arrive late and learners persist less	\$6.5M	–\$0.5M	2037

What the College watches for, and what it does

CASE	THE EARLY WARNING	THE RESPONSE
Enrolment twenty per cent lower	Enrolments against plan, two consecutive intakes	Hiring for the next intake is held to the enrolments achieved, and acquisition spend moves to the market converting best. The Validation tranche is not released until two intakes meet plan.
Continuation ten points lower	Continuation at any level five points below plan for two terms	The level learners leave from is reviewed academically, and advising on the routes affected is increased. The level fee is not cut.
Acquisition a quarter dearer	Cost per enrolment above plan for two consecutive terms	Spend moves to the channels with the lowest measured cost per enrolment. A market whose cost per enrolment stays above one level's contribution for two terms is paused.

What the College watches for, and what it does – continued

CASE	THE EARLY WARNING	THE RESPONSE
Acquisition at the benchmark averages	Cost per enrolment above \$2,000 in any market for two terms	Acquisition spend is released term by term against the measured cost per enrolment, never against the plan's schedule. The Validation gate tests it before the third tranche is drawn.
Academic pay fifteen per cent higher	Vacancies open more than one term	The tariff's annual indexation follows the pay of the people who deliver it. The Board may raise it above three per cent in the year the market moves.
Executive demand half the plan	Executive share of Gulf enrolments below plan for two intakes	Senior academic capacity is hired only against confirmed executive enrolments. The Tutored route takes the demand without any loss of standard.
Institutional agreements a year late	No signed agreement by the planned opening term	No institutional place is budgeted before an agreement is signed, and the partnerships post is created a term before the first agreement, not before the channel opens.
Gulf launch two terms late	Admissions not open by the planned term	The curriculum schedule holds. The Launch tranche is drawn only when admissions open.
Technology fifty per cent dearer	Platform spend above budget for two quarters	Technology is a small line; procurement is the response.
The pound ten per cent stronger	The dollar below its planning rate against sterling for a full term	Sterling costs are hedged a year ahead from the first year the College earns a surplus, and the tariff is reviewed if the rate stays above plan for a year.
Demand sensitive to price	Offer acceptance below plan in the premium routes	The route structure is the response: a learner who cannot pay for Tutored is offered Guided, not a discount.
Second tranche of capital two terms late	Tranche not drawn by the gate date	Hiring for the next phase waits for the tranche. The minimum cash balance is never used to bridge a late tranche.
A slow start	The warnings of each case it combines	The difference between this case and the central requirement is the contingency the founders should hold available and not draw.
A thinner premium market	The warnings of each case it combines	The premium routes carry the margin. If both fall short, the Tutored tariff is reviewed and senior capacity is not hired ahead of demand.
Partners slower than planned	The warnings of each case it combines	Signed agreements and continuation are both reported to the Board every term, as leading indicators of this case.

THE CONTINGENCY

A slow start, with the Gulf late, conversion lower and acquisition dearer together, needs \$2.20M more than the plan. The founders should hold that sum available and not draw it. The Validation gate in 2029 is designed to show, before the third tranche, whether it will be needed.

Ten-year roadmap

The decade one year at a time: what each year must achieve, how, with what, how it is measured, what it costs, and the decision the Board takes before the next begins.

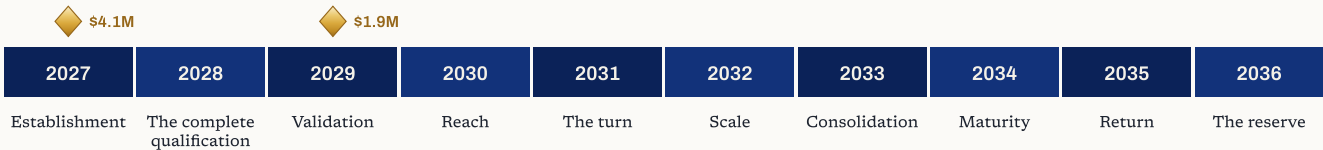
41	The decade at a glance	47	2032 · Scale
42	2027 · Establishment	48	2033 · Consolidation
43	2028 · The complete qualification	49	2034 · Maturity
44	2029 · Validation	50	2035 · Return
45	2030 · Reach	51	2036 · The reserve
46	2031 · The turn		

7.0 The decade at a glance

Each year of the plan has one objective, the actions that achieve it, the resources the model says it needs, the measures it is judged on, the money it requires, the decision the Board takes at its end and the condition that closes it. The words are the plan’s design; every number is read from the model for that year.

Ten years, ten gates

The phase of each year; gold marks the years in which a tranche of the founding capital is drawn



The ten years

YEAR	PHASE	OBJECTIVE	CAPITAL DRAWN	SURPLUS
2027	Establishment	Constitute the institution and teach its first intake to the standard it will keep.	\$4.09M	-\$1,582k
2028	The complete qualification	Teach every level of the qualification for the first time, and open the second market.	—	-\$1,645k
2029	Validation	Prove the academic and commercial model on measured results before the College draws the capital to expand.	\$1.95M	-\$770k
2030	Reach	Open the College's last two markets and its institutional channel.	—	-\$455k
2031	The turn	Pass the lowest point of the College's cash and earn its first surplus.	—	\$391k
2032	Scale	Bring every market to the acquisition budget its payback allows, and no further.	—	\$979k
2033	Consolidation	Run the institution at full scale on its own income.	—	\$1,524k
2034	Maturity	Operate at the volume the tariff was built on, and renew accreditation.	—	\$1,871k
2035	Return	Hold enough cash to return the founding capital in full.	—	\$1,998k
2036	The reserve	End the decade with the founding capital returnable and six months of cost held in reserve.	—	\$2,068k

ESTABLISHMENT

Constitute the institution and teach its first intake to the standard it will keep.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Incorporate, constitute the Board of Governors and adopt the academic and governance instruments
- ◆ Appoint the Principal, the Director of Academic Standards, the Registrar and the Head of Finance
- ◆ Author Levels I to III and their examinations across the two terms before launch, and Level IV in the launch term; build and independently test the platform
- ◆ Appoint the External Examiners before the first examination is set
- ◆ Open admissions in the Gulf and teach the first intake in the Autumn term

RESOURCES

8	11
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
8	11
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$1.29M	\$0.06M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

26	26
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
22	\$1,197
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$0.11M	-\$1.58M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

-\$1.58M	-\$1.58M	\$4.09M	Establishment \$1.52M; Launch \$2.56M
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

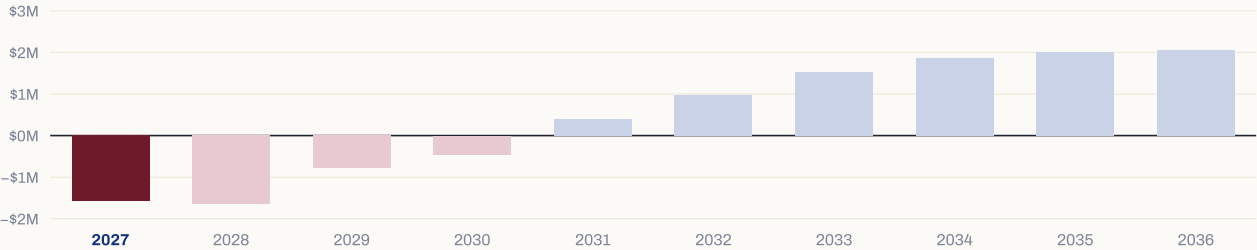
BOARD GATE

Launch: the Board releases the Launch tranche only when Levels I to III are authored and reviewed, the platform has passed its security test, and the academic offices and first instructors are in post

EXIT CONDITION

The first intake has sat its Level examination, every script has been second-marked, and the first moderation has been reported to the Board

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



THE COMPLETE QUALIFICATION

Teach every level of the qualification for the first time, and open the second market.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Author Levels V and VI, each in the term before it is first taught
- ◆ Open admissions in the United Kingdom and Europe
- ◆ Receive the External Examiners' first annual report and answer it in writing
- ◆ Confer the first awards at the sixth level in the Autumn term
- ◆ Open the employer channel in the Autumn term
- ◆ Commission the first independent audit of the College's accounts

RESOURCES

15	13
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
7	2
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$2.24M	\$0.29M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

174	145
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
252	\$1,265
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$1.20M	-\$1.64M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

-\$1.64M	-\$3.23M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

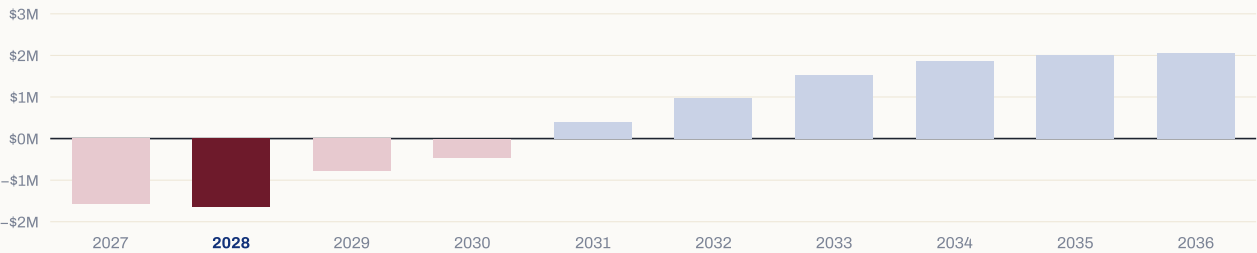
BOARD GATE

First-year review: the Board reviews continuation, the External Examiners' report and the measured cost of an enrolment against the plan, and confirms the acquisition budget for the year ahead

EXIT CONDITION

All six levels taught, examined and moderated at least once; the first audit signed

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



VALIDATION

Prove the academic and commercial model on measured results before the College draws the capital to expand.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Confer the six-level qualification on the first learners who entered at Level I
- ◆ Measure continuation, completion and the cost of an enrolment in each market over two full years
- ◆ Sign the first employer agreements and report their completion separately
- ◆ Prepare the West Africa and Asia launches and the institutional channel

RESOURCES

20	13
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
5	0
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$2.81M	\$0.45M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

325	267
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
607	\$1,392
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$2.83M	-\$0.77M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

-\$0.82M	-\$4.04M	\$1.95M	Validation \$1.95M
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

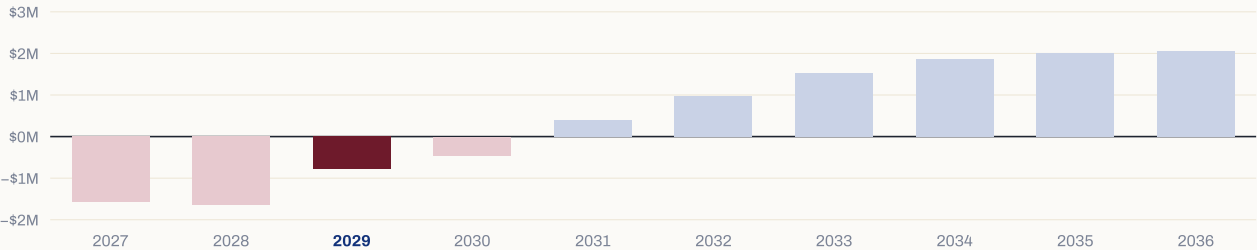
BOARD GATE

Validation: the Board releases the third tranche only on a full year of teaching, assessment, moderation and conferral reviewed by the External Examiners, continuation within five points of plan, and a measured cost of an enrolment within a quarter of plan

EXIT CONDITION

The third tranche released or withheld on the evidence, and the acquisition budget reset to measured cost

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



REACH

Open the College's last two markets and its institutional channel.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Open retail admissions in Asia and sign the first institutional agreements, in West Africa, Asia and the Gulf
- ◆ Apply to the British Accreditation Council for accreditation of the College's online provision and host its inspection
- ◆ Run the first annual quality review across all four markets

RESOURCES

27	14
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
7	1
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$3.55M	\$0.69M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

479	408
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
922	\$1,496
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$4.23M	-\$0.45M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

-\$0.55M	-\$4.59M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

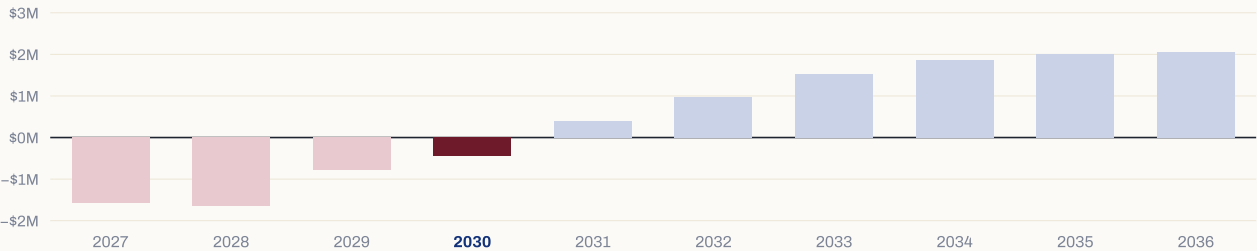
BOARD GATE

Reach: the Board confirms that each new market's first two intakes convert within a quarter of plan before its acquisition budget steps up

EXIT CONDITION

Four markets and both agreement channels open; the inspection completed

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



THE TURN

Pass the lowest point of the College's cash and earn its first surplus.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Hold hiring to the establishment the work requires, term by term
- ◆ Complete the accreditation body's interim inspection
- ◆ Renew or replace the External Examiners at the end of their four-year terms
- ◆ Begin hedging sterling costs a year ahead

RESOURCES

32	14
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
5	0
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$4.13M	\$0.86M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

640	545
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
1,304	\$1,581
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$5.85M	\$0.39M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

\$0.26M	-\$4.33M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

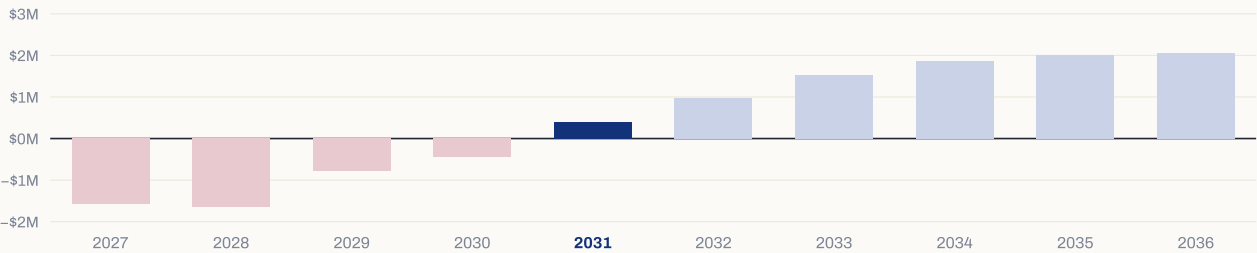
BOARD GATE

The turn: the Board confirms the trough has passed and that the remaining capital is not needed to reach the first surplus

EXIT CONDITION

A full year in which fees exceed the whole cost of the institution

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



SCALE

Bring every market to the acquisition budget its payback allows, and no further.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Take each market's acquisition budget to its final planned level
- ◆ Review every route's section sizes and advising hours against measured learner results
- ◆ Report learner results by route and by market to the Board, to test that every route delivers what it promises

RESOURCES

37	15
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
5	1
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$4.73M	\$0.99M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

761	651
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
1,616	\$1,651
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$7.23M	\$0.98M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

\$0.84M	-\$3.49M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

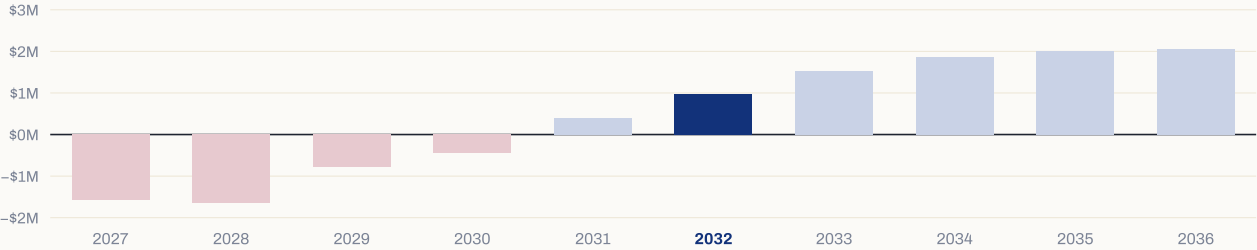
BOARD GATE

Scale: the Board confirms no market is funded past the level at which its last dollar pays back within a learner's first level

EXIT CONDITION

Every market at its planned budget, each inside its payback ceiling

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



CONSOLIDATION

Run the institution at full scale on its own income.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Review the curriculum of every level against five years of results, within the maintenance hours the establishment already carries
- ◆ Extend institutional agreements into second terms with the first buyers

RESOURCES

39	16
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
2	1
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$5.14M	\$1.04M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

838	719
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
1,835	\$1,684
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$8.25M	\$1.52M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

\$1.40M	-\$2.09M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

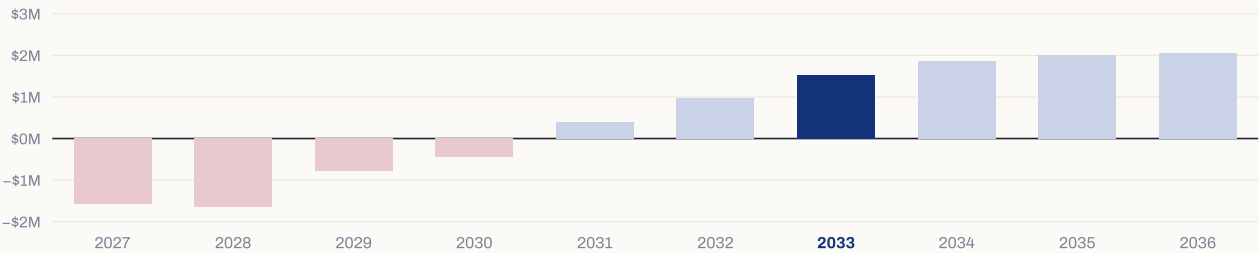
BOARD GATE

Consolidation: the Board confirms the College has met its costs from its own income for three consecutive years

EXIT CONDITION

The establishment stable at the size its work requires

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



MATURITY

Operate at the volume the tariff was built on, and renew accreditation.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Measure the year's cost of each route against the price build-up on which the tariff was set
- ◆ Complete the four-yearly re-inspection for accreditation
- ◆ Publish the College's first five-year report on learner results

RESOURCES

39	16
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
0	0
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$5.36M	\$1.06M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

858	738
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
1,937	\$1,718
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$8.84M	\$1.87M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

\$1.82M	-\$0.27M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

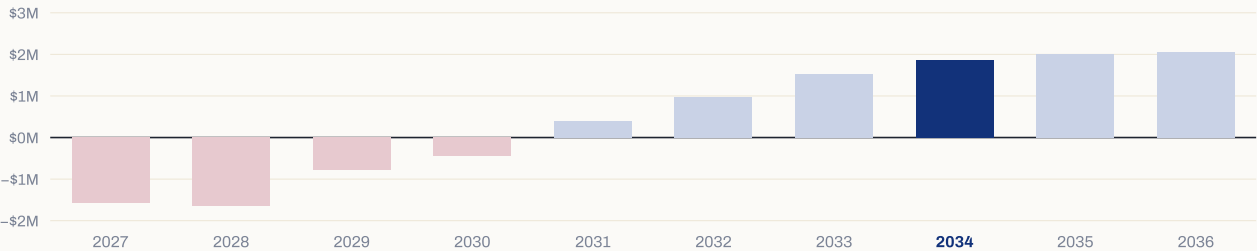
BOARD GATE

Maturity: the Board compares the year's actual cost of each route with the price build-up and resets the tariff if they differ

EXIT CONDITION

The tariff confirmed or reset on measured cost

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



RETURN

Hold enough cash to return the founding capital in full.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Agree with the founders the form and timing of the return of capital
- ◆ Build the reserve towards its target

RESOURCES

39	16
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
0	0
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$5.52M	\$1.08M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

858	740
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
1,950	\$1,752
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$9.15M	\$2.00M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

\$1.98M	\$1.70M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

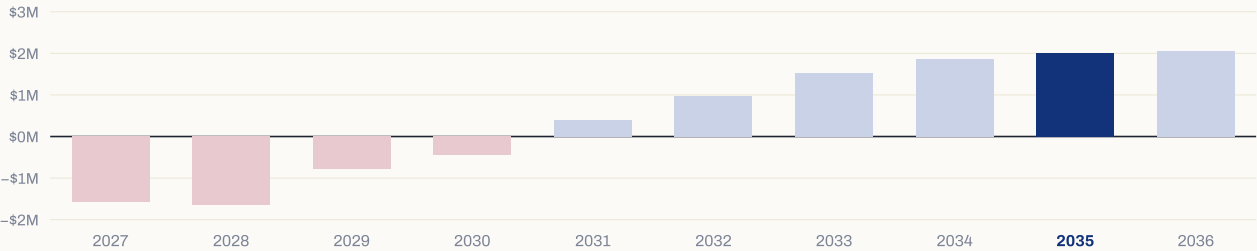
BOARD GATE

Return: the Board decides the return of capital, having confirmed the reserve is not drawn below its target to make it

EXIT CONDITION

The College's cash at or above the founding capital

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



THE RESERVE

End the decade with the founding capital returnable and six months of cost held in reserve.

ACTIONS

- ◆ Complete the reserve
- ◆ Present the Board with the second ten-year plan, built from the first decade's measured results

RESOURCES

39	16
ACADEMIC STAFF AT YEAR END	PROFESSIONAL STAFF AT YEAR END
0	0
ACADEMICS HIRED IN THE YEAR	PROFESSIONAL STAFF HIRED
\$5.69M	\$1.10M
PAYROLL	FINDING LEARNERS

MEASURES

858	740
NEW LEARNERS	STUDYING AT YEAR END
1,950	\$1,787
LEVELS COMPLETED	COST OF AN ENROLMENT
\$9.43M	\$2.07M
NET FEE REVENUE	SURPLUS OR DEFICIT

FINANCIAL REQUIREMENT

\$2.05M	\$3.75M	—	None
CASH FROM OPERATIONS	CUMULATIVE, BEFORE CAPITAL	CAPITAL DRAWN	TRANCHE RELEASED

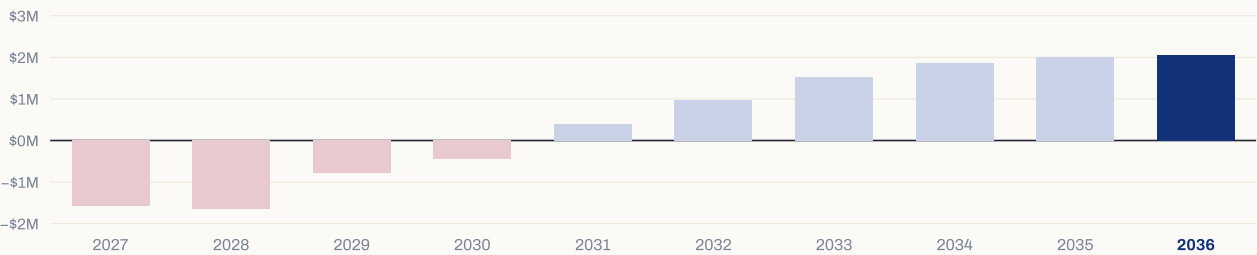
BOARD GATE

The plan's test: capital returnable and the reserve at target

EXIT CONDITION

The second ten-year plan adopted

THE YEAR IN THE DECADE · SURPLUS OR DEFICIT



Governance

Who decides what, how the academic standard is protected from commercial pressure, the gate at the end of each year, what the Board sees every term, and the risks it watches.

53	The Board of Governors	54	What the Board sees every term
53	Academic governance	55	The risk register
54	The gates		

8.1

The Board of Governors

The College is governed by a Board of 5 independent governors, meeting four times a year. The Board appoints the Principal, holds the College to this plan and takes the decisions the plan reserves to it.

DECISIONS RESERVED TO THE BOARD

- ◆ The release of each tranche of the founding capital, against its gate.
- ◆ The form of the founding capital and the terms of its return.
- ◆ The tariff, and any change to it beyond the annual indexation.
- ◆ Entry into a new market or channel, and the step-up of any market's acquisition budget.
- ◆ Any use of the reserve, and any fall of cash below the minimum.
- ◆ The appointment of the Principal and the academic offices, and of the External Examiners on the Director of Academic Standards' nomination.
- ◆ The adoption of the second ten-year plan.

8.2

Academic governance

The Director of Academic Standards is responsible for the qualification: its curriculum, its assessment and the standard at which it is awarded. Results are confirmed by the Examination Board before they are released, and the External Examiners report each year directly to the Board of Governors as well as to the Director.

Those who recruit learners take no part in assessing them. The Head of Marketing and Admissions reports to the Principal and has no role in marking, moderation or the Examination Board, and no fee, agreement or route changes the assessment a learner receives.

8.3 The gates

A decision at the end of every year

YEAR	THE BOARD CONFIRMS	CAPITAL
2027	Launch: the Board releases the Launch tranche only when Levels I to III are authored and reviewed, the platform has passed its security test, and the academic offices and first instructors are in post	\$4.09M
2028	First-year review: the Board reviews continuation, the External Examiners' report and the measured cost of an enrolment against the plan, and confirms the acquisition budget for the year ahead	—
2029	Validation: the Board releases the third tranche only on a full year of teaching, assessment, moderation and conferral reviewed by the External Examiners, continuation within five points of plan, and a measured cost of an enrolment within a quarter of plan	\$1.95M
2030	Reach: the Board confirms that each new market's first two intakes convert within a quarter of plan before its acquisition budget steps up	—
2031	The turn: the Board confirms the trough has passed and that the remaining capital is not needed to reach the first surplus	—
2032	Scale: the Board confirms no market is funded past the level at which its last dollar pays back within a learner's first level	—
2033	Consolidation: the Board confirms the College has met its costs from its own income for three consecutive years	—
2034	Maturity: the Board compares the year's actual cost of each route with the price build-up and resets the tariff if they differ	—
2035	Return: the Board decides the return of capital, having confirmed the reserve is not drawn below its target to make it	—
2036	The plan's test: capital returnable and the reserve at target	—

8.4 What the Board sees every term

The measures

MEASURE	PLAN	BROUGHT TO THE BOARD WHEN
New learners, by market	Stage VI and the roadmap, term by term	Two consecutive intakes below plan
Cost of an enrolment, by market	\$1,494 in the Gulf over the decade; each market's ceiling in Stage III	Above plan for two terms, or above the ceiling at all
Continuation and completion, by level	Stage II	Five points below plan at any level for two terms
Seminar cohorts	No cohort above its route's limit	Any cohort above the limit
Academic staff against the work	Always covered, hired a term ahead	A term in which admissions are held back
Cash against the minimum	Three months of the next term's cost	Headroom below one month
Agreements signed, and what institutions owe	Stage III	No agreement by the planned opening term; payment past terms
External Examiners' reports	Received and answered each year	Any finding on the standard

8.5

The risk register

The register is drawn from the model's own cases (Stage VI). Each risk is ranked by the additional capital the College would need if it happened and nothing were done; each has the early warning that would show it coming and the response the plan commits to.

Risks, their warnings and the responses

RISK	EARLY WARNING	RESPONSE	EXTRA CAPITAL
Acquisition at the benchmark averages	Cost per enrolment above \$2,000 in any market for two terms	Acquisition spend is released term by term against the measured cost per enrolment, never against the plan's schedule. The Validation gate tests it before the third tranche is drawn.	\$4.34M
The pound ten per cent stronger	The dollar below its planning rate against sterling for a full term	Sterling costs are hedged a year ahead from the first year the College earns a surplus, and the tariff is reviewed if the rate stays above plan for a year.	\$1.47M
Academic pay fifteen per cent higher	Vacancies open more than one term	The tariff's annual indexation follows the pay of the people who deliver it. The Board may raise it above three per cent in the year the market moves.	\$1.18M
Enrolment twenty per cent lower	Enrolments against plan, two consecutive intakes	Hiring for the next intake is held to the enrolments achieved, and acquisition spend moves to the market converting best. The Validation tranche is not released until two intakes meet plan.	\$1.03M
Acquisition a quarter dearer	Cost per enrolment above plan for two consecutive terms	Spend moves to the channels with the lowest measured cost per enrolment. A market whose cost per enrolment stays above one level's contribution for two terms is paused.	\$0.86M
Demand sensitive to price	Offer acceptance below plan in the premium routes	The route structure is the response: a learner who cannot pay for Tutored is offered Guided, not a discount.	\$0.53M
Continuation ten points lower	Continuation at any level five points below plan for two terms	The level learners leave from is reviewed academically, and advising on the routes affected is increased. The level fee is not cut.	\$0.32M
Gulf launch two terms late	Admissions not open by the planned term	The curriculum schedule holds. The Launch tranche is drawn only when admissions open.	\$0.19M
Technology fifty per cent dearer	Platform spend above budget for two quarters	Technology is a small line; procurement is the response.	\$0.04M
Institutional agreements a year late	No signed agreement by the planned opening term	No institutional place is budgeted before an agreement is signed, and the partnerships post is created a term before the first agreement, not before the channel opens.	\$0.00M
Second tranche of capital two terms late	Tranche not drawn by the gate date	Hiring for the next phase waits for the tranche. The minimum cash balance is never used to bridge a late tranche.	\$0.00M

Risks, their warnings and the responses – continued

RISK	EARLY WARNING	RESPONSE	EXTRA CAPITAL
Executive demand half the plan	Executive share of Gulf enrolments below plan for two intakes	Senior academic capacity is hired only against confirmed executive enrolments. The Tutored route takes the demand without any loss of standard.	-\$0.10M

Investment case

What the founders are asked to commit and against which decisions, what the capital builds, when it can be returned, how it is protected, and what would change the case.

58	What is asked
58	What it builds
58	When it returns

59	How the capital is protected
59	What would change the case

9.1

What is asked

The founders are asked to commit \$6.03M to establish the College, released in three tranches against three decisions of the Board, and to hold a further \$2.20M available against a slow start.

\$1.52M ESTABLISHMENT, SPRING 2027 The founding capital is committed and the Board constituted	\$2.56M LAUNCH, AUTUMN 2027 Levels I to III authored and reviewed, the platform tested, the academic offices and the first instructors in post	\$1.95M VALIDATION, SPRING 2029 A full year of teaching, assessment, moderation and conferral completed and reviewed by the External Examiner; continuation within five points of plan
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The form of the capital, whether equity, loan, grant or a combination, is reserved to the founders and the Board. The plan sizes the requirement and the gates against which it is released; it does not assume the form, and nothing in the model depends on it.

9.2

What it builds

By 2036 the capital has built an institution teaching about 740 learners at any time, admitting about 860 a year across four markets and two agreement channels, and employing 55 people: 39 academics and 16 professional staff. It awards its own qualification at six levels, examined and double-marked at every level, on a platform it owns, and keeps a permanent record of every award it has made. It takes \$9.4M a year in fees and spends \$7.4M.

9.3

When it returns

Spring 2031 LOWEST CASH –\$4.65M before capital	2031 FIRST SURPLUS Fees exceed the whole cost of the institution	2035 CAPITAL RETURNABLE Cash from operations covers the founding capital	\$3.75M CASH, END 2036 Against a reserve target of \$3.68M
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The plan’s test is that by the end of 2036 the College holds enough cash from its own operations to return every dollar of founding capital and still hold six months of operating cost in reserve. The fees are set to pass that test and no more: the margin in every fee is the smallest that does.

9.4

How the capital is protected

- ◆ **Gates.** No tranche is released until the Board confirms the College has done what the previous one was for, and the third waits for a full year of measured results.
- ◆ **A minimum balance.** The College never plans to hold less than three months of the cost of the term ahead.
- ◆ **Fees before teaching, never before the level.** A learner pays at the start of each level, so the College is paid for the teaching it is about to do and holds no one's money for teaching it has not begun.
- ◆ **Staff against work.** Academics are hired only for the work the learners present require, a term ahead; the establishment grows by thresholds, not by ambition.
- ◆ **Acquisition within its payback.** No market is funded past the point at which its last dollar is repaid within a learner's first level, and budgets step up only when the market before has converted to plan.
- ◆ **A reserve.** Six months of operating cost by the end of the decade, to teach every enrolled learner to the end of their level and to carry a year in which enrolment falls and cost does not.

9.5

What would change the case

Four things would change the case most. The first is the cost of finding a learner: at the benchmark's averages rather than its medians, the College would need \$10.4M and could not return its capital within the decade, which is why acquisition is measured before the third tranche is drawn and budgets are released against measured cost. The second is sterling: a pound ten per cent stronger for the whole decade adds \$1.47M to the capital needed. The third is the pay of academics: fifteen per cent higher adds \$1.18M. The fourth is enrolment: a fifth lower in every market and channel adds \$1.03M.

The same model shows the upside. Markets half as large again would lower every fee, the Guided level from \$3,000 to \$2,600, for \$0.75M more capital; twice as large, to \$2,400 for \$1.43M more. The first two years of recruitment will show which is nearer the truth.

THE DECISION

To commit \$6.03M in three tranches against the Establishment, Launch and Validation gates; to hold \$2.20M available and undrawn; and to decide the form of the capital.

Appendices

The basis of the plan, every assumption with its source, the model term by term, the work behind each route, and the terms this plan uses.

61	A · The basis of the plan	75	D · The work of each route
62	B · Every assumption and its source	75	E · Terms used in this plan
74	C · The model, term by term		

A

The basis of the plan

Every number in this plan descends from 202 assumptions held in the plan’s own record. Each carries one of three bases, and the basis says how much weight it can bear.

The three bases

BASIS	WHAT IT MEANS	COUNT
Evidence	A published external source: a government rate, a survey, a vendor’s price page, a benchmark study. Each names the page it was read from and the date.	70
Specification	A decision the plan makes for the institution: what a route provides, how the qualification is assessed, how fast the College enters its markets. It is right by definition and changed only by decision.	73
Judgement	A planning assumption where no evidence exists before the College operates: how many learners continue, how many choose each route, how far a market can be pushed. Each is replaced by the College’s own measurement as it arrives, and reported to the Board.	59

The evidence was gathered for this edition from primary sources and checked by reading each page, not a summary of it. A figure that could not be traced to a page that was actually read was not used, however plausible. Where a source is dated, as university fees for external examiners and US-weighted acquisition benchmarks are, the plan treats it as a floor or a proxy and says so beside it.

Three kinds of figure the plan never contains: a figure from any earlier document of the College, which is built from nothing; a claim to any accreditation, recognition or partnership, of which the College will hold none when it opens; and a named person in an office they have not accepted.

B Every assumption and its source

The register

Grouped by the part of the record it belongs to

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
THE QUALIFICATION			
Levels	6 levels	Specification	Six levels, A1 to C2 on the CEFR
Level names	A1, A2, B1, B2, C1, C2	Specification	The six levels of the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages
Modules a level	10 modules	Specification	Ten modules a level, each a unit of assessed study
Terms a year	3 terms	Specification	Three intakes a year: Spring, Summer, Autumn
Months a term	4 months	Specification	One level is studied across one four-month term
Teaching weeks a term	12 weeks	Specification	Twelve teaching weeks in each term, the balance given to examination, moderation and conferral
quizzes per level	10 quizzes	Specification	One machine-marked quiz a module, low-stakes by design
Assignments a level	10 scripts	Specification	One assignment a module, marked by a person against a rubric published before the work
Examinations a level	1 sittings	Specification	A three-hour written paper and a recorded spoken paper at the end of each level
Share of scripts second-marked	1 share of judged marks	Specification	Every judged mark is read by a second marker before it reaches the candidate
Scripts needing reconciliation	12%	Judgement	Share of scripts on which the two readings differ by more than the three-point tolerance and a third reading is opened; replaced by the College's own marker-agreement record after the first two terms
Effort of a reconciliation	60%	Judgement	A third reading addresses only the disputed criteria, so costs less than a full first reading
Resit rate	8%	Judgement	Share of candidates taking the one re-sit the regulations allow; a zero-revenue event that costs a new paper, a new sitting and a new double marking
Candidates per invigilator	25 candidates	Judgement	Online invigilation, one invigilator to a sitting group
Length of the examination sitting	3.50 hours	Specification	Three-hour paper plus admission and technical check
First marking, an assignment	10, 12, 15, 18, 22, 26	Judgement	Minutes to mark one assignment by level — a C2 script is longer and harder to judge than an A1 script
First marking, a written paper	25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50	Judgement	Minutes to mark one written examination script, criterion by criterion
First marking, a spoken paper	12, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22	Judgement	Minutes to mark one recorded spoken paper
Moderation, per level taught	5 hours per level per term	Judgement	The moderation panel closes each level's batch each term within five working days, re-reading a sample
Moderation sample	10%	Specification	A tenth of the batch is re-read in moderation
Examination Board	12 academic hours per term	Judgement	The Examination Board sits once a term to confirm results and authorise conferral
Paper versions a level a year	3 versions	Specification	A new paper each term, so that a re-sit never meets the paper it failed and no task is reused within a year
Writing one paper version	30 academic hours	Judgement	Authoring, rubric, trial marking and review of one paper version
Curriculum maintenance	8 academic hours	Judgement	Annual revision of each module against what teaching and assessment show

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Quality review	160 academic hours	Judgement	The annual review cycle: curriculum, assessment, learner experience, teaching, standards, platform and outcomes
Writing a module	70 academic hours	Judgement	Writing one module of assessed online study from nothing: learning materials, activities, quiz bank, assignment and rubric, review and accessibility check
Levels written ahead	1 terms	Specification	Each level is authored and reviewed at least one full term before its first learners reach it
THE ROUTES			
Independent: adviser	0.50 hours per learner per level	Specification	Placement, progression advice and a substantive reply to any academic question
Guided: seminar hours	24 hours per section per level	Specification	Two hours of scheduled seminar teaching a week across the twelve teaching weeks
Guided: largest cohort	14 learners	Specification	A seminar cohort is capped at fourteen
Guided: feedback per assignment	6 minutes per script	Specification	Structured written feedback on each assignment, beyond the mark
Guided: progress monitoring	0.50 hours per learner per level	Specification	Progress monitored by the seminar teacher, with an intervention where a learner falls behind
Guided: adviser	0.50 hours per learner per level	Specification	As Independent
Tutored: seminar hours	24 hours per section per level	Specification	Two hours of scheduled seminar teaching a week across the twelve teaching weeks, as on Guided
Tutored: largest cohort	10 learners	Specification	A smaller cohort of ten
Tutored: tutorials	8 hours per learner per level	Specification	Individual tutorials with a named instructor across the level
Tutored: feedback per assignment	12 minutes per script	Specification	Personalised feedback on each assignment, keyed to the learner's own progress record
Tutored: adviser	1.50 hours per learner per level	Specification	A named academic adviser for the whole qualification
Tutored: progress review	1 hours per learner per level	Specification	A structured progress review at the end of each level
Executive: seminar hours	24 hours per section per level	Specification	The qualification's seminar programme, taught in a closed professional cohort
Executive: leadership strand	8 hours per section per level	Specification	The English of leadership — presentation, negotiation, correspondence and the conduct of meetings — taught in the same cohort; supplementary to the qualification and not assessed differently
Executive: largest cohort	6 learners	Specification	A closed cohort of six
Executive: tutorials	12 hours per learner per level	Specification	Individual sessions scheduled around the learner's professional obligations
Executive: feedback per assignment	15 minutes per script	Specification	Feedback written for professional use
Executive: adviser	2 hours per learner per level	Specification	An individual academic plan agreed at entry and reviewed at every level
Executive: senior oversight	2 hours per learner per level	Specification	Senior academic oversight of the learner's route

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Executive: administration	3 administrative hours per learner per level	Specification	Diary negotiation, priority response and the coordination an executive relationship requires
Executive: writing the leadership strand	60 academic hours	Judgement	Authoring the leadership strand once for each level, before the route first opens
Bespoke: tutorials	40 hours per learner per level	Specification	The whole teaching programme delivered one to one
Bespoke: feedback per assignment	20 minutes per script	Specification	Feedback written for the holder's own professional context
Bespoke: adviser	3 hours per learner per level	Specification	An individual academic plan, agreed and reviewed with the holder
Bespoke: senior oversight	3 hours per learner per level	Specification	Senior academic oversight
Bespoke: material written for the learner	15 academic hours per learner per level	Specification	Material written to the holder's professional domain — curriculum cost that cannot be shared with anyone
Bespoke: administration	5 administrative hours per learner per level	Specification	Dedicated administration
PROGRESSION			
Completion by level	83%, 86%, 88%, 89%, 90%, 91%	Judgement	Share of those beginning a level who complete it
Continuation by level	74%, 78%, 81%, 84%, 87%	Judgement	Share of those completing a level who begin the next in the following term
Placement by level	34%, 26%, 20%, 12%, 6%, 2%	Judgement	The level at which new learners are placed: most enter at A1 or A2, few at C1 or above
MARKETS AND ACQUISITION			
Enquiries that apply	26.2%	Evidence	Set so that the whole funnel turns 9.0% of enquiries into enrolments — the ratio of the median cost per enquiry (\$106) to the median cost per enrolled student (\$1,173) in professional, continuing and online programmes. The benchmark's averages (\$140 and \$2,849) imply 4.9%, which the plan tests as a named shock. Search Influence and UPCEA, higher education marketing benchmarks — searchinfluence.com/blog/2026-higher-education-marketing-benchmarks (2024 study of professional, continuing and online programmes, restated 21 May 2026)
Applicants placed	75%	Judgement	Share of applicants who complete the placement assessment
Placed applicants offered	92%	Judgement	Share of placed applicants who receive an offer at a level the College teaches
Offers accepted	50%	Judgement	Share of offers accepted and paid
Saturation	30%	Judgement	Elasticity of the cost of an enquiry to spend above the reference level: doubling spend beyond it raises the cost of each enquiry by about a quarter
Enquiry to enrolment	1 terms	Judgement	An enquiry becomes an enrolment in the following term; acquisition is spent a term ahead of the revenue it produces
The Gulf: cost of an enquiry	\$106	Evidence	Median cost per enquiry for professional, continuing and online programmes. No published figure for this market survived verification, so the plan applies the benchmark unchanged rather than assume a cheaper market; the College's first campaigns replace it. Search Influence and UPCEA, higher education marketing benchmarks — searchinfluence.com/blog/2026-higher-education-marketing-benchmarks (2024 study of professional, continuing and online programmes, restated 21 May 2026)
The Gulf: reference budget	\$150,000	Judgement	Annual spend above which the cost of an enquiry begins to rise

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
The Gulf: route mix	independent 15%; guided 35%; tutored 28%; executive 17%; bespoke 5%	Judgement	Retail mix of routes chosen, informed by the market's evidenced willingness to pay for group teaching and for executive instruction
The Gulf: budget by year	2027 \$60k; 2028 \$180k; 2029 \$240k; 2030 \$300k; 2031 \$330k; 2032 \$360k	Specification	The acquisition budget the plan commits; held at the last stated level thereafter
The Gulf: cards by class	international 1	Specification	Cards issued in the Gulf are international cards to a UK Stripe account
The United Kingdom and Europe: cost of an enquiry	\$106	Evidence	Median cost per enquiry for professional, continuing and online programmes. No published figure for this market survived verification, so the plan applies the benchmark unchanged rather than assume a cheaper market; the College's first campaigns replace it. Search Influence and UPCEA, higher education marketing benchmarks — searchinfluence.com/blog/2026-higher-education-marketing-benchmarks (2024 study of professional, continuing and online programmes, restated 21 May 2026)
The United Kingdom and Europe: reference budget	\$120,000	Judgement	Annual acquisition spend in this market above which each further enquiry costs more
The United Kingdom and Europe: route mix	independent 25%; guided 40%; tutored 25%; executive 8%; bespoke 2%	Judgement	Retail mix of routes chosen in this market, informed by its evidenced willingness to pay
The United Kingdom and Europe: budget by year	2028 \$90k; 2029 \$150k; 2030 \$200k; 2031 \$240k	Specification	The acquisition budget the plan commits in this market; held at the last stated level thereafter
The United Kingdom and Europe: cards by class	ukStandard 35%; ukPremium 15%; eea 50%	Judgement	Half the market's learners are expected to pay with UK cards, a third of those premium cards, and half with EEA cards; the College's first year of payments replaces it
West Africa: route mix	None	Specification	No route at retail: every route costs more to deliver than the market's published prices. West Africa is served through institutional agreements
West Africa: budget by year	None	Specification	No retail acquisition spend; the market is reached through the partnerships team
Asia and the wider world: cost of an enquiry	\$106	Evidence	Median cost per enquiry for professional, continuing and online programmes. No published figure for this market survived verification, so the plan applies the benchmark unchanged rather than assume a cheaper market; the College's first campaigns replace it. Search Influence and UPCEA, higher education marketing benchmarks — searchinfluence.com/blog/2026-higher-education-marketing-benchmarks (2024 study of professional, continuing and online programmes, restated 21 May 2026)
Asia and the wider world: reference budget	\$80,000	Judgement	Annual acquisition spend in this market above which each further enquiry costs more
Asia and the wider world: route mix	independent 45%; guided 40%; tutored 15%	Judgement	Independent and the group-taught routes
Asia and the wider world: budget by year	2030 \$60k; 2031 \$100k; 2032 \$130k	Specification	The acquisition budget the plan commits in this market; held at the last stated level thereafter. The last step is held to \$130,000, inside the ceiling at which the last dollar still pays back within a learner's first level
Asia and the wider world: cards by class	international 1	Specification	Cards issued outside the UK and the EEA are international cards to a UK Stripe account
Employers: discount	15%	Specification	The College's partner band for an agreement of ten to ninety-nine places
Employers: places per agreement	10 learners	Judgement	A department or cohort of staff

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Employers: agreements by year	2028 2; 2029 5; 2030 8; 2031 10; 2032 12	Specification	Agreements the partnerships team is resourced to win
Employers: cost to win one	\$6,000	Judgement	Travel, proposal and negotiation for each agreement won, beyond the team's own salaries
Employers: paid within	45 days	Judgement	Invoiced per term; paid on employer terms
Employers: where signed	gulf 60%; ukEurope 40%	Judgement	Where employer agreements are expected to be signed
Institutions and sponsors: discount	20%	Specification	The College's partner band for an agreement of a hundred places or more
Institutions and sponsors: places per agreement	60 learners	Judgement	A funded cohort
Institutions and sponsors: agreements by year	2030 1; 2031 2; 2032 3; 2033 4	Specification	As employers
Institutions and sponsors: cost to win one	\$25,000	Judgement	A long sale against an institutional budget cycle
Institutions and sponsors: paid within	90 days	Judgement	Public and charitable buyers pay on longer terms
Institutions and sponsors: where signed	westAfrica 50%; asia 30%; gulf 20%	Judgement	Where institutional agreements are expected to be signed
PUBLISHED PRICES IN THE MARKETS			
British Council, Saudi Arabia: in dollars	\$1,610	Evidence	British Council, Saudi Arabia, Adult English, 40 credits over four months, 60 contact hours: SAR 6,037.50 incl. VAT. saudiarabia.britishcouncil.org/en/english/courses-adults/classes/programmes-pricing ; converted at the riyal's fixed rate of 3.75 to the dollar, researched 19 Sep 2026
British Council, Saudi Arabia: in dollars	\$2,131	Evidence	British Council, Saudi Arabia, Adult English, 60 credits over six months, 90 contact hours: SAR 7,992.50 incl. VAT. saudiarabia.britishcouncil.org/en/english/courses-adults/classes/programmes-pricing ; converted at the riyal's fixed rate of 3.75 to the dollar, researched 19 Sep 2026
British Council, United Arab Emirates: in dollars	\$803	Evidence	British Council, United Arab Emirates, IELTS preparation course, 24 hours: AED 2,950. britishcouncil.ae/en/english/adults/ielts-preparation ; converted at the dirham's fixed rate of 3.6725 to the dollar, researched 19 Sep 2026
University of Chester: in dollars	\$4,495	Evidence	University of Chester, Pre-sessional English, 13 weeks: £3,350. chester.ac.uk/international/pre-sessional-english-language-courses ; converted at the plan's rate of 1.3417, researched 19 Sep 2026
University of Stirling: in dollars	\$6,910	Evidence	University of Stirling, Pre-sessional English, 8 weeks, online: £5,150. stir.ac.uk/international/international-students/pre-sessional-english-language-courses ; converted at the plan's rate of 1.3417, researched 19 Sep 2026
University of Oxford Language Centre: in dollars	\$4,361	Evidence	University of Oxford Language Centre, Pre-sessional Academic English, 6 weeks: £3,250. lang.ox.ac.uk/summer-presessional-english-course ; converted at the plan's rate of 1.3417, researched 19 Sep 2026
PEI Centre, Lagos: in dollars	\$49	Evidence	PEI Centre, Lagos, IELTS training, one month: NGN 75,000. peicentre.com/ielts-training-fees ; converted at NGN 1,540 to the dollar, the rate on the research date, researched 19 Sep 2026
PEOPLE AND PAY			
Employer's National Insurance	15%	Evidence	Employer Class 1 National Insurance, 2026/27. HMRC, Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027 — gov.uk/guidance/rates-and-thresholds-for-employers-2026-to-2027 , retrieved 23 Sep 2026

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
National Insurance threshold	£5,000	Evidence	Employer NI secondary threshold, £5,000 a year, 2026/27; held flat through the plan. HMRC, Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027 — gov.uk/guidance/rates-and-thresholds-for-employers-2026-to-2027 , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Pension	5%	Specification	The College pays five per cent of salary into a workplace pension — above the statutory employer minimum of three per cent of qualifying earnings (GOV.UK, Workplace pensions: what you, your employer and the government pay, retrieved 23 Sep 2026)
Employment Allowance	£10,500	Evidence	Employment Allowance: reduces the employer's National Insurance bill by up to £10,500 a year. HMRC, Rates and thresholds for employers 2026 to 2027 — gov.uk/guidance/rates-and-thresholds-for-employers-2026-to-2027 , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Apprenticeship Levy	0.50%	Evidence	Apprenticeship Levy: 0.5% of the annual pay bill, payable where the pay bill exceeds £3 million. HMRC, Pay Apprenticeship Levy — gov.uk/guidance/pay-apprenticeship-levy , updated 6 Apr 2026
Levy allowance	£15,000	Evidence	Levy allowance of £15,000 a year set against the levy. HMRC, Pay Apprenticeship Levy — gov.uk/guidance/pay-apprenticeship-levy , updated 6 Apr 2026
Salary survey year	2025	Evidence	The survey salaries are for April 2025 (ONS, ASHE 2025 provisional — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours , released 23 Oct 2025). Each is carried forward from 2025 at the annual pay rise, so the plan's first-year salaries already include two years of increases
Cost of a hire	12%	Judgement	Advertising, assessment and onboarding of one hire, as a share of first-year salary
Annual pay rise	3%	Judgement	Salaries rise three per cent a year across the establishment
Instructor: salary	£42,218	Evidence	Further education teaching professionals (SOC 2312), UK median — the occupation closest to teaching and marking a six-level examined qualification. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 14.7a, full-time gross annual pay — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/occupation4digitsoc2010ashtable14 , released 23 Oct 2025
Senior academic: salary	£52,835	Evidence	Higher education teaching professionals (SOC 2311), UK median — the grade that teaches the Executive and Bespoke routes and leads ten instructors. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 14.7a, full-time gross annual pay — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/occupation4digitsoc2010ashtable14 , released 23 Oct 2025
Contracted hours	1,650 hours	Specification	A full-time academic contract of 37.5 hours a week across 44 working weeks
Share of time delivering	72%	Judgement	Share of contracted time spent teaching, marking, tutoring and advising; the rest is preparation, standardisation and professional development
Share, on private schedule	58.0%	Judgement	An academic held available around learners' own calendars cannot be block-scheduled; the lost fraction is what private scheduling costs
Academics per lead	10 instructors	Specification	One academic lead manages, observes and standardises ten instructors
Principal and Chief Executive: salary	£83,623	Evidence	Head teachers and principals (SOC 2321), UK upper quartile; the London median is not published. The head of an institution that awards its own qualification is set at the upper quartile of its occupation. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 14.7a, full-time gross annual pay — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/occupation4digitsoc2010ashtable14 , released 23 Oct 2025
Director of Academic Standards: salary	£59,897	Evidence	Education managers (SOC 2322), UK upper quartile — the most senior academic manager below the Principal. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 14.7a, full-time gross annual pay — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/occupation4digitsoc2010ashtable14 , released 23 Oct 2025

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Registrar: salary	£49,031	Evidence	Education managers (SOC 2322), London median — the head of the registry and the record. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Head of Finance: salary	£61,549	Evidence	Financial accounts managers (SOC 3534), London median. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Platform Engineer: salary	£75,296	Evidence	Programmers and software development professionals (SOC 2134), London median. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Head of Marketing and Admissions: salary	£60,658	Evidence	Marketing and commercial managers (SOC 2432), London median. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Admissions Officer: salary	£33,939	Evidence	Other administrative occupations n.e.c. (SOC 4159), London median. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Learner Services Officer: salary	£33,730	Evidence	Welfare and housing associate professionals (SOC 3229), London median — the closest occupation to learner support. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Examinations Officer: salary	£33,939	Evidence	Other administrative occupations n.e.c. (SOC 4159), London median; no reliable published figure exists for examinations officers alone. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Quality and Compliance Officer: salary	£46,581	Evidence	Education managers (SOC 2322), UK median — a post below the Registrar, set at the national median of the same occupation. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 14.7a, full-time gross annual pay — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/occupation4digitsoc2010ashtable14 , released 23 Oct 2025
Head of Institutional Partnerships: salary	£60,658	Evidence	Marketing and commercial managers (SOC 2432), London median — the occupation that sells to institutions. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Executive Programmes Coordinator: salary	£33,939	Evidence	Other administrative occupations n.e.c. (SOC 4159), London median. ONS, Annual Survey of Hours and Earnings 2025 (provisional), Table 15, full-time gross annual pay by region — ons.gov.uk/employmentandlabourmarket/peopleinwork/earningsandworkinghours/datasets/regionbyoccupation4digitsoc2010ashtable15 , released 23 Oct 2025
Fewest hires a term	3 people	Judgement	However small the establishment, the College can recruit at least three academics in a term

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Fastest growth a term	35%	Judgement	Beyond that, the academic establishment can grow by about a third in a term; faster than that, recruitment and standardisation cannot keep the standard
THE PLATFORM			
Application hosting and compute: fixed monthly charge	\$5	Evidence	Workers Paid plan, \$5 a month minimum; includes the D1 database allowances. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Application hosting and compute: requests per learner a month	4,000 requests	Judgement	About 130 page and application requests on each day of a month of study — lessons, submissions, recordings, results and messages
Application hosting and compute: requests included	10,000,000 requests	Evidence	10 million requests a month included. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Application hosting and compute: per million requests	\$0.3	Evidence	\$0.30 per additional million requests. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Application hosting and compute: compute per request	10 CPU milliseconds	Judgement	Average compute time of one request, generous for an application that mostly reads and writes records
Application hosting and compute: compute included	30,000,000 CPU milliseconds	Evidence	30 million CPU milliseconds a month included. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Application hosting and compute: per million CPU ms	\$0.02	Evidence	\$0.02 per additional million CPU milliseconds. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Academic record database: rows written per learner a month	3,000 rows	Judgement	Attendance, submissions, marks, second marks, feedback and messages written for one learner in a month
Academic record database: rows written included	50,000,000 rows	Evidence	D1: first 50 million rows written a month included (25 billion rows read are also included, far beyond the College's use). Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Academic record database: per million rows written	\$1	Evidence	D1: \$1.00 per additional million rows written. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Academic record database: record size per learner	5 MB	Judgement	The permanent academic record of one learner: enrolment, marks, feedback and award — kept for as long as the College exists
Academic record database: storage included	5 GB	Evidence	D1: first 5 GB of storage included. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Academic record database: per GB-month	\$0.75	Evidence	D1: \$0.75 per additional GB-month. Cloudflare, Workers pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/workers/platform/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Recordings and submissions storage: storage per learner-level	0.80 GB	Judgement	Recorded spoken papers, speaking practice and ten submitted assignments a level
Recordings and submissions storage: per GB-month	\$0.015	Evidence	R2 Standard storage, \$0.015 per GB-month; egress is free, and request charges (\$4.50 and \$0.36 per million) are negligible at the College's volume. Cloudflare, R2 pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/r2/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Recordings and submissions storage: retention	72 months	Specification	Assessment evidence is retained for six years after it is made, the College's own retention period for assessment records

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Recordings and submissions storage: storage included	10 GB	Evidence	R2: 10 GB-month of storage free each month. Cloudflare, R2 pricing — developers.cloudflare.com/r2/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Transactional email: price by monthly volume	0: \$0; 3,000: \$20; 50,000: \$35; 100,000: \$160; 200,000: \$350; 500,000: \$650	Evidence	Resend transactional plans by monthly volume: free to 3,000; Pro \$20 for 50,000 and \$35 for 100,000; Scale \$160 for 200,000, \$350 for 500,000, \$650 for 1,000,000. Resend, pricing — resend.com/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Transactional email: emails per learner a month	12 emails	Judgement	Enrolment, schedule, results, moderation and conferral notices
Live classroom licences: per licence a month	\$14.16	Evidence	Zoom Workplace Pro, \$14.16 per user a month billed annually; education pricing (\$10) is not assumed, because the College's eligibility is unconfirmed. Zoom, pricing — zoom.us/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Staff productivity suite: per user a month	\$12	Judgement	A planning allowance for a business email, calendar and document suite for every member of staff; no vendor price page could be read to confirm it, and the College's first purchase replaces it
Independent security testing: a year	£6,250	Evidence	One independent web application penetration test a year by a CREST-accredited UK provider, at the top of the published range (£3,750 to £6,250 and more; about £1,200 a day for three to five days). Precursor Security, Penetration testing cost — precursorsecurity.com/services/offensive-security/penetration-testing/cost , updated August 2026
Perpetual registry and verification: per award-holder a year	5%	Judgement	Storage and serving of the permanent record for every award-holder, for as long as the College exists — the one cost whose driver never decays
PREMISES, ASSURANCE AND GOVERNANCE			
Registered office: a year	£299.88	Evidence	A London registered office and mail address at £24.99 a month. The Hoxton Mix, virtual office pricing — hoxtonmix.com/virtual-office-london-old-street , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Serviced office, London: per desk a month	£640	Evidence	Serviced office desk, Farringdon — the London submarket closest to the City at a mid-market rate (the index runs £620 Shoreditch to £865 Soho). LondonOffices.com, London office cost price index 2026 — londonoffices.com/london-office-cost-price-index-2026 , published 11 Sep 2026
Serviced office, London: desks per professional	0.50 desks per person	Specification	Leadership, registry and administration work hybrid; one desk for every two
Insurance: professional indemnity, employers' liability, cyber: a year	\$9,000	Judgement	A planning allowance for professional indemnity, public and employers' liability, cyber and directors' cover. The published price for a small education business is far lower — £457.52 a year for £10 million of public and employers' liability with professional indemnity (Simply Business, education insurance, data 1 Jan–30 Jun 2026) — but an institution that holds learners' records and confers awards carries cover a consultancy does not. Employers' liability of at least £5 million is a legal requirement (GOV.UK, Employers' liability insurance)
Insurance: professional indemnity, employers' liability, cyber: share of revenue	0.20%	Judgement	Premiums rise with turnover and enrolment
Independent audit: policy	Voluntary	Specification	At the scale of this plan the College meets two of the three small-company tests — turnover up to £15 million, assets up to £7.5 million, 50 employees or fewer — and is exempt from statutory audit (GOV.UK, Audit exemptions for private limited companies, retrieved 23 Sep 2026). It is audited anyway, from its second year, because founders and a Board require audited accounts
Independent audit: fee by turnover	0: £6,000; 1,000,000: £12,000; 5,000,000: £25,000	Evidence	Audit fee by the previous year's turnover, at the top of each published band: under £1 million £3,000–£6,000; £1–5 million £5,000–£12,000; £5–15 million £10,000–£25,000. Audit Group, statutory audit costs 2025/26 — auditgroup.co.uk/statutory-audit-costs , retrieved 23 Sep 2026

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Accounting system, payroll and tax compliance: a month	£55	Evidence	Xero Comprehensive, £55 a month. Xero, UK pricing plans — xero.com/uk/pricing-plans , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Accounting system, payroll and tax compliance: per person paid a month	£1.5	Evidence	Xero payroll, £1.00 to £1.50 for each person paid; the top of the range. Xero, UK pricing plans — xero.com/uk/pricing-plans , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Accounting system, payroll and tax compliance: a year	£1,800	Evidence	Year-end accounts and corporation tax return prepared externally, at the top of the published range for a limited company (£1,200–£1,800); the Head of Finance keeps the books. Sleek UK, cost of running a limited company — sleek.com/uk/resources/cost-of-running-a-limited-company , published 10 Aug 2026
Legal and company secretarial: a year	\$20,000	Judgement	Contracts, agreements with institutional buyers, employment and data protection advice
Establishment: incorporation, instruments and terms: once	\$45,000	Judgement	Incorporation, the academic and governance instruments, learner terms and contracts, drafted and reviewed before the first intake
Data protection registration: a year	£78	Evidence	ICO data protection fee, tier 2 (small and medium organisations), £78 a year. Information Commissioner's Office — ico.org.uk/for-organisations/data-protection-fee , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
External Examiners: examiners	3 examiners	Specification	One External Examiner for each pair of levels, appointed for four years, one of whom is appointed Chief External Examiner
External Examiners: per examiner a year	£600	Evidence	University of Essex annual fee for an undergraduate award of nine or more modules, £600 — a floor, dated to 2024/25. University of Essex, Fees and expenses for external examiners — essex.ac.uk/staff/academic-standards-and-quality/fees-and-expenses-external-examiners , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
External Examiners: chief examiner's supplement	£150	Evidence	Supplement for a Senior External Examiner, £150 (University of Dundee, policy and code of practice on external examining — dundee.ac.uk , AY2024–25)
Independent accreditation: British Accreditation Council, Online, Distance and Blended Learning: decision	Apply	Specification	The College applies for accreditation of its online provision once three years of teaching can be inspected. A cost of seeking recognition; not a claim the College holds it
Independent accreditation: British Accreditation Council, Online, Distance and Blended Learning: application	£551	Evidence	Application fee, non-refundable. British Accreditation Council, Guide to Accreditation and Inspection Fees 2026/27 — the-bac.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/BAC-Fees-Brochure-2026-27.pdf
Independent accreditation: British Accreditation Council, Online, Distance and Blended Learning: inspection management	£2,095	Evidence	Inspection management fee, UK provider. British Accreditation Council, Guide to Accreditation and Inspection Fees 2026/27 — the-bac.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/BAC-Fees-Brochure-2026-27.pdf
Independent accreditation: British Accreditation Council, Online, Distance and Blended Learning: inspection	£7,789	Evidence	Inspection fee, three inspectors for three days — the top of the table (£865 for one inspector for one day). British Accreditation Council, Guide to Accreditation and Inspection Fees 2026/27 — the-bac.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/BAC-Fees-Brochure-2026-27.pdf

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Independent accreditation: British Accreditation Council, Online, Distance and Blended Learning: interim inspection	£992	Evidence	Interim inspection within twelve months of accreditation, £992 a day (UK); one day. British Accreditation Council, Guide to Accreditation and Inspection Fees 2026/27 — the-bac.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/BAC-Fees-Brochure-2026-27.pdf
Independent accreditation: British Accreditation Council, Online, Distance and Blended Learning: accreditation cycle	4 years	Evidence	Accreditation runs for four years before full re-inspection. British Accreditation Council, Guide to Accreditation and Inspection Fees 2026/27 — the-bac.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/BAC-Fees-Brochure-2026-27.pdf
Independent accreditation: British Accreditation Council, Online, Distance and Blended Learning: annual fee by enrolment	0: £1,842; 3,001: £3,070; 8,001: £3,930	Evidence	Annual accreditation fee by learners enrolled: £1,842 up to 3,000; £3,070 to 8,000; £3,930 above. British Accreditation Council, Guide to Accreditation and Inspection Fees 2026/27 — the-bac.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/06/BAC-Fees-Brochure-2026-27.pdf
Companies House: once	£100	Evidence	Incorporation of a private limited company online, £100. Companies House fees — gov.uk/government/publications/companies-house-fees/companies-house-fees , updated 2 Jul 2026
Companies House: a year	£50	Evidence	Annual confirmation statement filed online, £50. Companies House fees — gov.uk/government/publications/companies-house-fees/companies-house-fees , updated 2 Jul 2026
Board of Governors: members	5 members	Specification	Five independent governors
Board of Governors: per member a year	\$6,000	Judgement	An honorarium and expenses for four meetings a year
POLICY			
First year	2027	Specification	The plan's first year
Last year	2036	Specification	The plan's tenth year
Exchange rate	\$1.34	Evidence	Mean of the twelve HMRC monthly exchange rates for the US dollar, October 2025 to September 2026 (1.3126 to 1.3647). HMRC monthly exchange rates — trade-tariff.service.gov.uk/exchange_rates , retrieved 23 Sep 2026. The College earns in dollars and pays in pounds; a stronger pound is tested as a named shock
Inflation	2%	Evidence	Prices other than pay rise at 2% a year, the inflation target of both the Bank of England (bankofengland.co.uk/monetary-policy/inflation) and the US Federal Reserve (federalreserve.gov/faqs/economy_14400.htm). Pay rises at its own rate (people.json)
Price base year	2026	Specification	Every price other than pay — technology, premises, assurance, acquisition — is stated as published or planned in 2026 and carried forward from 2026 at the inflation rate
Paid by card	85%	Judgement	Share of learner fees paid by card; the balance by bank transfer
UK standard cards	1.50%	Evidence	Standard UK cards, 1.5% + 20p. Stripe, UK pricing — stripe.com/gb/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
UK premium cards	2.80%	Evidence	Premium UK cards, 2.8% + 20p. Stripe, UK pricing — stripe.com/gb/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
EEA cards	2.50%	Evidence	EEA cards, 2.5% + 20p. Stripe, UK pricing — stripe.com/gb/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
International cards	3.15%	Evidence	International cards, 3.15% + 20p. Stripe, UK pricing — stripe.com/gb/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026

The register – continued

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS	SOURCE OR REASONING
Currency conversion	2%	Evidence	An additional 2% where currency conversion is required. Fees are charged in dollars and the College settles in pounds, so the plan charges it on every card payment. Stripe, UK pricing — stripe.com/gb/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Fixed per payment	£0.2	Evidence	20p per successful card payment. Stripe, UK pricing — stripe.com/gb/pricing , retrieved 23 Sep 2026
Payments per level	1.60 transactions per learner per level	Judgement	Most learners pay each level in one payment; some by instalment
Billed	Level	Specification	Fees are billed per level, at the start of the level. A learner never pays for a level before it begins, so the College holds no untaught fees in advance
Withdrawn and refunded	3%	Judgement	Share of level starts withdrawn inside the fourteen-day window, refunded in full
Fee indexation	3%	Specification	Fees rise each year with the cost of the people who deliver them
Fees rounded to	\$50	Specification	A level fee is stated to the nearest fifty dollars
One price worldwide	Yes	Specification	A route costs the same wherever the learner lives. The College's response to a market that cannot pay for a route is to offer it there through an institutional buyer, not to sell it more cheaply
Pricing volume year	2034	Specification	Institutional costs are absorbed over the volume the plan reaches at maturity, not over the thin first years; the difference is what the founding capital is for
Reserve target	6 months of operating cost	Specification	Six months of operating cost held as an institutional reserve — enough to teach every enrolled learner to the end of the level they have begun and to meet a year in which enrolment falls and cost does not
Minimum cash	3 months of operating cost	Specification	The College never plans to hold less than three months of operating cost in cash
Hired ahead	1 terms	Specification	An instructor is hired and paid from the term before the learners who need them arrive
Capital returnable by	2036	Specification	The plan must be able to return the founding capital by the end of its tenth year while holding its reserve at target
Form of capital	Reserved	Specification	The form of the founding capital — equity, loan, grant or a combination — is a decision reserved to the founders and the Board. The plan sizes the requirement and the gates against which it is released; it does not assume the form

C

The model, term by term

Thirty terms

US dollars in the money of each term, thousands

TERM	NEW	STUDYING	ACADEMICS	STAFF	NET FEES	COST	SURPLUS	CUMULATIVE
Spring 2027	0	0	3 + 0	9	\$0k	\$464k	-\$464k	-\$464k
Summer 2027	0	0	4 + 1	15	\$0k	\$571k	-\$571k	-\$1,035k
Autumn 2027	26	26	5 + 2	19	\$106k	\$653k	-\$546k	-\$1,582k
Spring 2028	26	42	7 + 3	23	\$181k	\$854k	-\$673k	-\$2,255k
Summer 2028	74	103	7 + 4	26	\$424k	\$962k	-\$539k	-\$2,794k
Autumn 2028	74	145	8 + 5	28	\$593k	\$1,025k	-\$433k	-\$3,226k
Spring 2029	94	189	10 + 5	30	\$776k	\$1,148k	-\$372k	-\$3,624k
Summer 2029	116	237	11 + 6	32	\$967k	\$1,214k	-\$247k	-\$3,883k
Autumn 2029	116	267	12 + 6	33	\$1,082k	\$1,234k	-\$151k	-\$4,043k
Spring 2030	116	285	14 + 7	38	\$1,186k	\$1,542k	-\$356k	-\$4,406k
Summer 2030	182	360	16 + 7	40	\$1,442k	\$1,561k	-\$120k	-\$4,579k
Autumn 2030	182	408	17 + 7	41	\$1,606k	\$1,584k	\$21k	-\$4,592k
Spring 2031	182	438	19 + 8	44	\$1,759k	\$1,794k	-\$34k	-\$4,653k
Summer 2031	229	504	21 + 8	46	\$1,979k	\$1,841k	\$138k	-\$4,578k
Autumn 2031	229	545	21 + 8	46	\$2,116k	\$1,829k	\$288k	-\$4,330k
Spring 2032	229	570	23 + 8	50	\$2,265k	\$2,069k	\$196k	-\$4,167k
Summer 2032	266	620	24 + 8	51	\$2,429k	\$2,074k	\$355k	-\$3,875k
Autumn 2032	266	651	25 + 8	52	\$2,532k	\$2,104k	\$428k	-\$3,487k
Spring 2033	266	670	26 + 8	54	\$2,672k	\$2,239k	\$433k	-\$3,092k
Summer 2033	286	700	26 + 8	54	\$2,762k	\$2,225k	\$537k	-\$2,610k
Autumn 2033	286	719	27 + 8	55	\$2,817k	\$2,262k	\$554k	-\$2,090k
Spring 2034	286	730	27 + 8	55	\$2,934k	\$2,334k	\$600k	-\$1,528k
Summer 2034	286	735	27 + 8	55	\$2,950k	\$2,318k	\$631k	-\$908k
Autumn 2034	286	738	27 + 8	55	\$2,958k	\$2,318k	\$640k	-\$274k
Spring 2035	286	740	27 + 8	55	\$3,050k	\$2,384k	\$666k	\$371k
Summer 2035	286	740	27 + 8	55	\$3,050k	\$2,384k	\$666k	\$1,037k
Autumn 2035	286	740	27 + 8	55	\$3,050k	\$2,384k	\$666k	\$1,703k
Spring 2036	286	740	27 + 8	55	\$3,142k	\$2,452k	\$689k	\$2,374k
Summer 2036	286	740	27 + 8	55	\$3,142k	\$2,452k	\$689k	\$3,064k
Autumn 2036	286	740	27 + 8	55	\$3,142k	\$2,452k	\$689k	\$3,753k

D The work of each route

Academic hours per learner per level at the plan’s pricing volume in 2034, and the resulting cost of the route’s own teaching and assessment at 2027 prices. Seminar hours are the route’s seminar timetable divided among the learners the plan actually places in each cohort.

Hours and cost of a level

ROUTE	ASSESSMENT	SEMINAR	INDIVIDUAL	TOTAL HOURS	COHORT FILL	GRADE	COST
Independent	8.1	0.0	0.5	8.6	—	Instructor	\$513
Guided	8.0	1.9	2.0	11.9	90%	Instructor	\$716
Tutored	8.1	2.6	12.5	23.2	91%	Instructor	\$1,392
Executive	8.1	8.3	18.5	34.9	64%	Senior	\$3,261
Bespoke	8.1	0.0	64.3	72.4	—	Senior	\$6,764

E Terms used in this plan

TERM	MEANING
Level	One of the six stages of the qualification, A1 to C2, each a qualification in its own right, studied over one term.
Route	One of the five ways of studying for the qualification, defined by the support the learner receives.
Pathway	All six levels of a route; its price is six level fees.
Term	Four months, the unit in which the College teaches, examines and admits. There are three a year.
Cohort	A seminar group on the Guided, Tutored or Executive route; each route sets its largest size.
Second marking	Every assessed script is marked independently by two examiners.
Moderation	A review each term of a sample of marked work at every level, to hold marking to one standard.
Examination Board	The body that confirms results before they are released.
External Examiner	An academic from outside the College who reviews the standard of its awards and reports to the Board.
Placement	The assessment that decides the level at which a new learner begins.
Continuation	The share of learners completing a level who begin the next in the following term.
Cost of an enrolment	What the College spends on finding learners in a market, divided by the learners it enrolls there.
Contribution of a level	A level fee less the route’s own teaching and assessment and the cost of collecting it.
Payback ceiling	The budget beyond which a market’s last dollar of acquisition would not be repaid within a learner’s first level.
Tranche	A part of the founding capital, released at a Board gate.
Gate	A decision the Board takes, on stated evidence, before the plan moves to its next phase.
Minimum balance	Three months of the cost of the term ahead, which the College always holds.
Reserve	Six months of operating cost, held by the end of the decade.

TERM	MEANING
Margin	The share of each fee that is not a cost; solved as the smallest that returns the capital and completes the reserve.
Pricing volume	The volume in 2034 over which the institution’s shared costs are spread to build each fee.
Financial constitution	The shares of fee income that each part of the institution consumes, read from the model.